
The Christian Life New Testament

Fifteen Master Outlines

Bible Study Guide

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Name

Master Outline — What the Christian Life New Testament Can Do for You

What the Christian Life New Testament Can Do for You

The Christian Life New Testament was designed to assist the believer in spiritual growth and practical service. It can fill a need in the life of the average Christian and change his or her life-style.

From guilty to not guilty.

From death to life.

From darkness to light.

From hatred to love.

From weakness to power.

From bondage to freedom.

From tribulation to triumph.

From grief to joy.

From gloom to glory.

From defeat to victory.

From failure to success.

From fear to faith.

From I can't to I can.

To get the most out of your Christian Life New Testament begin each study session with prayer. Ask the Holy Spirit to be your teacher and fill you with His power and give you a knowledge of His Word as you study. Remember that the Holy Spirit is the author of the Bible. "For prophecy never came by the will of man, but holy men of God spoke as they were moved by the Holy Spirit" (2 Pet. 1:21).

Do not rush through these Master Outline studies. They were prepared to be pondered over. Read them over and over; read them slowly and thoughtfully. Take time to look up each scripture reference and examine its contents that you may grasp what the Holy Spirit is teaching. Ask yourself, "How can this scripture apply to me?" Know that "all Scripture is given by inspiration of God, and is profitable for doctrine, for reproof, for correction, for instruction in righteousness, that the man of God may be complete, thoroughly equipped for every good work" (2 Tim. 3:16, 17). All Scripture is profitable to all believers in one way or another. Some scriptures will lead you to repentance; others can fill you with joy. Some scriptures will reveal the will of God, while others will put you under conviction of sin. Some scriptures will tell you of the love of God. Other scriptures will speak of His wrath.

Let me give you eight good reasons why you should study the Master Outlines in this New Testament.

- (1) Study for a biblical foundation on which to grow.
- (2) Study for spiritual strength and power for this life in a world under the curse of sin.
- (3) Study that you may grow in Bible knowledge.
- (4) Study that you may be a success to the glory of God.
- (5) Study and give the Holy Spirit the opportunity to motivate you to greater things for the Lord.
- (6) Study that you may know God's perfect will for your life.

(7) Study that you may be an effective soul winner.

(8) Study so that you may “sanctify [set apart] the Lord God in your hearts, and always be ready to give a defense to everyone who asks you a reason for the hope that is in you, with meekness and fear” (1 Pet. 3:15).

When you fail to study God’s Word you stop growing. When you cease to grow spiritually you start deteriorating immediately. When you stop climbing you start slipping. You can never arrive spiritually in this life; there is always a higher plateau to be reached.

One of those plateaus is personal evangelism. The Christian Life New Testament can help you to reach this plateau. Jesus said, “Follow Me, and I will make you fishers of men” (Matt. 4:19). Soul winners are made, not born. Master Outline Number Fifteen is a mini-syllabus on New Testament evangelism. It can help you to become a spiritual fisherman, because:

(1) It is small enough for the lady’s handbag and the man’s pocket.

(2) It is with you when you need it for witnessing or counseling.

(3) The Master Outlines and notes on the great doctrines of the Bible are so simple that anyone can understand the profound teachings of Jesus.

(4) It can give you confidence to share your faith with the lost.

(5) It will help you to answer some of the doctrinal questions you may be asked when discipling the lost for salvation. Let me give you a few examples from personal experience.

1. You may be asked to prove that the Bible is the Word of God. Never say that you can prove anything; you will only end up in an argument. Say something like this: “I will be glad to tell you why I believe the Bible is the Word of God.” Now turn to Point Number One, “THE BIBLE CLAIMS TO BE THE INSPIRED WORD OF GOD.” Read Second Timothy 3:16, 17 and the note I(A) on inspiration.

Now read Point Number Two, “THE BIBLE IS A DIFFICULT BOOK.” Read First Corinthians 2:14–16 and the note II(A) on difficulties.

Then turn to Point Number Three, “THE BIBLE IS A BOOK OF ONENESS.” Read Second Peter 1:21 and the note III(A) on the unity of the Bible.

Now give your personal experience of salvation—How you are now a new creature in Christ, the old things are passed away, and all things are new. Then say something like this: “This is why I believe the Bible is God’s Word.” Above all, trust the Holy Spirit to convict of sin.

2. You may be asked to prove the existence of God. Again, I caution you, do not try to prove anything. Say, “I will be happy to show you why I believe in the existence of God.” Then read Hebrews 11:5, 6 and the note I(A) on the existence of God. Again, trust the Holy Spirit to use His Word.

3. You may be asked to explain the Trinity of God. Read Matthew 3:16, 17 and the note V(A).

4. You may be asked to prove the Godhead of Jesus. Read John 1:1 and the note I(A) for the scriptural evidence of His deity.

When you become acquainted with the Christian Life New Testament, you will be able to answer some of the doctrinal questions you may be asked while sharing your faith or teaching a class. You will share your faith with some who will have spiritual hang-ups. You will need to help them with their doctrinal problems before you can lead them through “GOD’S PLAN OF SALVATION” and invite them to accept Christ as their personal Savior.

Years ago as I sat in my study meditating on Proverbs 23:7, I felt inspired to make a few simple notes. Now when things go wrong and I get down in the dumps I read “As a Man Thinks.” I have read it hundreds of times and it always motivates me to press on for my Lord and Savior Jesus Christ.

Here it is:

To help overcome fear born of an inferior feeling and develop a positive mental attitude, read “As a Man Thinks” every day until it becomes a vital part of your daily thinking, motivating a change in your life-style from fear to faith. Remember, God said, “As he thinks in his heart, so is he” (Prov. 23:7).

AS A MAN THINKS

Today I will think like a dynamic servant of God, because I am what I think.

I am not always what I think I am; I am what I think.

I am not what I eat; I am what I think.

Clothes do not make the man; thinking makes the man.

Therefore, I will keep my thought processes active and open to the voice of God.

God did not call me to a life of failure, but to a life of success. This being so, I cannot fail as long as I do His will, allowing Him to work in and through me, motivating my every thought.

Because my God is a big God, I will think big with confidence, knowing my thoughts can never be bigger than my God.

Today I will think like the apostle Paul when he said: “I can do all things through Christ who strengthens me” (Phil. 4:13).

The Christian Life New Testament will help you mature spiritually. “To be carnally [sensuously] minded is death, but to be spiritually minded is life and peace” (Rom. 8:6). Tell me how you think and I will tell you whether you are a carnal Christian or a spiritual Christian. Remember, you are what you think.

I challenge you to compare your spirituality with that of the early Christians.

(1) They were accused of:

- a. Filling Jerusalem with the gospel. (See Acts 5:28.)
- b. Turning the world upside down. (See Acts 17:6.)

When they shared the gospel the people acted or reacted. On the day of Pentecost the hundred and twenty Spirit-filled believers left the upper room with the gospel. And as they shared it with the people, the people were confounded, amazed, and marveled. Some mocked and some inquired, asking, “Men and brethren, what shall we do?” (See Acts 2.) The point I wish to make is this: Some acted, accepting Christ as personal Savior, while others

reacted, mocking. BUT NO ONE IGNORED THOSE HOLY SPIRIT-FILLED CHRISTIANS.

They were spiritual because they had a knowledge of the gospel and the filling of the Holy Spirit. They were thinking like the dynamic Christians they were. Now do you have the courage to ask yourself, Am I carnal or spiritual?

(2) Evidence of a Spirit-filled believer according to the New Testament:

They were bold to share the gospel with the lost.

They witnessed with great power.

They shared with great grace.

They shared their treasure, talent, and time.

They worshipped in the Spirit.

They suffered persecution and gloried in tribulations.

They sang in prison, and loved and prayed for their executioners.

They rejoiced to suffer shame for Jesus.

They went everywhere proclaiming the gospel.

(3) Now let us look at a few characteristics of spiritual Christians:

They do not care who gets the credit as long as God gets the glory.

They do not have chips on their shoulders, but they do take up their crosses daily and follow Jesus.

They ignore molehills and by faith move mountains.

They have the ability to adjust without compromising principles.

They can adapt to a changing world without letting the world change them.

The question is, Am I a spiritual Christian? Only you can answer that question.

Here are some of the things you can do for your Lord and Savior Jesus Christ using the Christian Life New Testament.

(1) You can disciple the lost for salvation, person to person. Master Outline Number Fifteen, “HOW TO WITNESS EFFECTIVELY,” will teach you how to present Master Outline Number Fourteen, “GOD’S PLAN OF SALVATION.”

(2) You can disciple the lost for salvation by having a home Bible study for unsaved relatives, friends, and acquaintances. Have enough Christian Life New Testaments to loan one to each one present. Choose a mature Christian to lead the class—a teacher who will guide the discussion and get the class to participate. You will rejoice over the results.

(3) You can disciple the young believer for service on a one-to-one basis, or you can have a home Bible class, study the fifteen Master Outlines and watch these new Christians grow in the grace and knowledge of Christ.

(4) If you have an opportunity to share with a backslider, take him through Master Outlines, “THE ABUNDANT LIFE,” and “REPENTANCE.”

The Christian Life New Testament is great for:

Family devotions,

Memorizing scriptures,

Personal Bible study and devotions,
Giving as a gift to the saved or unsaved.

My prayer is that you will commit your all to the Lord Jesus Christ and take this tool and GO WITH THE GOSPEL.

Porter Barrington
Evangelist

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Index of Master Outlines

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How to Use the Outline

THE CHRISTIAN LIFE STUDY OUTLINES AND NOTES

The Christian Life Master Outlines and Notes are the amplification of a ministry of over thirty-five years, both in the pastorate and in the field of teaching and evangelism. These lessons by Porter Barrington on the great doctrines of the Bible are simple without being ordinary, short without being shallow, brief without being dwarfed, positive without being stilted, and comprehensive without being complicated.

They were produced to fill a need in the life of the average Christian, to provide an incentive to know more of God's Holy Word. If diligently studied, they will help to establish you in the faith and give you spiritual confidence.

It is suggested that you study the Master Outlines in the order given: one each day for fifteen days, and at the end of fifteen days, you will know more about the New Testament than you ever thought possible in such a short time. This study is equal to an advanced college course in Systematic Theology. If you review these lessons often, you will continue to grow in the knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ.

To begin your study of the Bible with the Christian Life Outlines and Notes, turn to the pages following this introduction. Here you will find the fifteen MASTER OUTLINES on the great doctrines of the New Testament. It is suggested that you follow them in the order given, you take time to read each Scripture reference found in the notes.

To illustrate the MASTER OUTLINE system, we begin with MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER ONE: THE BIBLE—THE WORD OF GOD. You will find the introduction followed by five points. After reading the introduction, begin your study with point number I as follows:

I. THE BIBLE CLAIMS TO BE THE INSPIRED WORD OF GOD (Now turn to 2 Tim. 3:16, 17.)

After reading 2 Tim. 3:16, 17, you will see the capital letter A, preceding verse sixteen, and another capital letter A below the chapter, followed by an explanation of that Scripture under point number I.

At the bottom of the note it reads, "Now turn to 1 Cor. 2:14-16," for point number II: THE BIBLE IS A DIFFICULT BOOK. In this manner, each point is linked with the next until you conclude with the last point in MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER FOURTEEN.

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER FIFTEEN should be studied as a guide to witnessing, after the believer is "grounded in the faith." Do not neglect this important opportunity for Christians to effectively share your faith.

Now look at the MASTER OUTLINES and begin your quest for the abundant Christian life.

CHRISTIAN LIFE STUDY OUTLINES

Master Outline 1

THE BIBLE—THE WORD OF GOD

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER ONE

The Bible—The Word of God

It is so important for a young Christian to start right; therefore, the first lesson is designed to help establish your faith in the Bible, for it is the Word of God.

Keep in mind that the Bible is not a book of philosophy, although it is philosophical. Do not go to the Bible for a scientific treatise. However, there is no discrepancy between ascertained facts of science and the Bible. The Bible is not a book of history, but is found to be accurate when recording history. The Bible was given to man from God, revealing Jesus Christ, the Son of God, and God the Son, the only Savior (John 14:6). He is the center and the circumference. It is Christ from Genesis to Revelation (John 5:39).

The Bible is as high above all other books as the heavens are above the earth. Someone has said of the Bible: “Read it to be wise, believe it to be safe, and practice it to be right.”

I. THE BIBLE CLAIMS TO BE THE INSPIRED WORD OF GOD

II. THE BIBLE IS A DIFFICULT BOOK

III. THE BIBLE IS A BOOK OF ONENESS

IV. THE BIBLE CLAIMS SPECIAL POWER

V. THE BIBLE COMMANDS THE BELIEVER TO STUDY THE SCRIPTURES

I. 2 Tim. 3:16, 17

“All Scripture is given by inspiration of God.” By “inspiration” we mean that the Holy Spirit exerted His supernatural influence upon the writers of the Bible. Therefore the Scriptures are God inspired word for word. By this we mean that every word, in the original, is fully and equally inspired in all of its teachings. The Bible does not just contain the Word of God; it is the Word of God.

The writers of the Bible did not write by natural inspiration, or an act of the human will. “Holy men of God spoke as *they were* moved by the Holy Spirit” (2 Pet. 1:21). David said, “The Spirit of the **LORD** spoke by me, And His word was on my tongue” (2 Sam. 23:2 OT).

(1) The Holy Spirit is the author of the Bible (2 Pet. 1:21).

(2) Man is the instrument used by the Holy Spirit to write the Bible.

(3) Results: The infallible Word of God. Therefore, the Bible is free from error and absolutely trustworthy (Ps. 119:89 OT; also Matt. 24:35).

Now turn to 1 Cor. 2:14-16, for point number II: THE BIBLE IS A DIFFICULT BOOK.

II. 1 Cor. 2:14-16

The Bible is a difficult book because it came from the infinite to the finite—from the unlimited, all powerful God, to limited man. Therefore, you cannot understand the Bible as you would understand the writings of Plato or Socrates. You can study the great philosophers with the natural mind, and by diligent application, grasp their profound meanings. If the Bible could be understood by natural man, it would be a natural book, and could not be the Word of God. Since the Bible is from God, and therefore spiritual, before you can receive its teachings, you must be born of the Spirit (*John 3:6*) and filled with the Spirit (*Eph. 5:18*). Always approach the Bible praying that the Spirit will be your teacher and will guide you to a better understanding of His Holy Word; or it will remain a difficult, closed book (*John 16:12-15*).

Now turn to 2 Pet. 1:21, for point number III: THE BIBLE IS A BOOK OF ONENESS.

III. 2 Pet. 1:21

The oneness or unity of the Bible is a miracle. It is a library of 66 books, written by over 35 different authors, in a period of approximately 1,500 years. Represented in the authors is a cross section of humanity, educated and uneducated, including kings, fishermen, public officials, farmers, teachers, and physicians. Included in the subjects are religion, history, law, science, poetry, drama, biography, and prophecy. Yet its various parts are as harmoniously united as the parts that make up the human body.

For 35 authors, with such varied backgrounds, to write on so many subjects over a period of approximately 1,500 years in absolute harmony, is a mathematical impossibility. It could not happen! Then how do we account for the Bible? The only adequate explanation is: “Holy men of God spoke *as they were* moved by the Holy Spirit” (verse 21).

Now turn to Heb. 4:12, for point number IV: THE BIBLE CLAIMS SPECIAL POWER.

IV. Heb. 4:12

“For the word of God is living and powerful....”

- (1) The Bible claims dividing power as a sword (above verse 12). The Bible will separate man from sin (*Ps. 119:11 OT*), or sin will separate man from the Bible (*Is. 59:2 OT*).
- (2) The Bible claims reflecting power as a mirror (*James 1:22-25*). In the Bible we see ourselves as God sees us—as sinners (*Rom. 3:23*).
- (3) The Bible claims cleansing power as water (*Eph. 5:26*). David prayed that God would wash him from iniquity and cleanse him from sin (*Ps. 51:2 OT*).
- (4) The Bible claims reproductive power as seed (*1 Pet. 1:23*). We are children of God, because we have been born into the family of God by the incorruptible seed of God. This is the new birth (*John 3:1-7*).
- (5) The Bible claims nourishing power as food (*1 Pet. 2:2*). The Bible is spiritual food for the soul. No Christian can remain strong in the Lord and not study the Word of God.

Now turn to 2 Tim. 2:15, for point number V: THE BIBLE COMMANDS THE BELIEVER TO STUDY THE SCRIPTURES.

V. 2 Tim. 2:15

“Be diligent to present yourself approved to God” is a command. As you study the Bible, you will discover that it does not just contain the Word of God—it IS the WORD of God. You must also keep in mind that the Word of God contains the WORDs of God, as well as the words of Satan, demons, angels, and man—both good and bad. God is truth and cannot lie. Satan “is a liar and the father of it” (*John 8:44*). Man is natural and is therefore limited and does not always speak the truth. To illustrate: *Matt. 22:15-46*. In this portion of Scripture, we have the words of Jesus, of the Pharisees, of the Herodians, and of the Sadducees. The Pharisees, Herodians, and Sadducees were trying to entangle Jesus in His teachings, that they might accuse Him of breaking God’s law. Their words were spoken with evil intent, revealing the thinking of the natural man, along with the words of God that came from the lips of Jesus.

As you study the Bible, ask yourself these questions:

- (1) Who is speaking: God, demon, angel, or man?
- (2) To whom is He speaking: to the nation Israel, to the Gentiles, to the Church, to men in general, or to some individual man or being?
- (3) How can this Scripture be applied to my own life to make me a better Christian?

Now turn to Master Study Outlines for lesson number two.

Master Outline 2

GOD

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER TWO

God

The Bible reveals God as the only Infinite and Eternal Being, having no beginning and no ending. He is Creator and Sustainer of all things. He is the Supreme Personal Intelligence, and Righteous Ruler of His universe. He is life, and therefore, the only source of life (John 5:39).

Man is natural and cannot know God by wisdom. “Can you search out the deep things of God?” (Job 11:7 OT). God is a person and can be known only by revelation. In the Old Testament He revealed Himself to and through His prophets. In the New Testament He reveals Himself through His Son Jesus Christ (Heb. 1:1-3).

I. THE EXISTENCE OF GOD

II. THE PERSONALITY OF GOD

III. THE NATURE OF GOD

IV. THE GRACE OF GOD

V. THE TRINITY OF GOD

I. *Heb. 11:5, 6*

The Bible nowhere attempts to prove or argue the existence of God. “For he who comes to God must believe that He is.” The existence of God is a fact taken for granted by the writers of both the Old and New Testaments. “In the beginning God” (*Gen. 1:1 OT*): The Bible opens by announcing the sublime fact of God and His existence. There are arguments for the existence of God; they are not conclusive, but are food for thought:

- (1) Universal belief in God comes from within man. It is innate in man, and comes from rational intuition.
- (2) The argument from “cause and effect.” Everything that began owes its existence to a cause. We have a watch; we must have a watchmaker. We have a building; we must have a builder. We have a creation; then we must have a creator. This creation could not have come into existence without an intelligent, personal creator any more than the alphabet could produce a book itself without an author.
- (3) The argument from anthropology. Man’s moral and intellectual nature argues for a moral and intellectual creator.
- (4) The Bible and the Christ that it reveals, His virgin birth, His sinless life, His vicarious death, and His bodily resurrection—all of this and much, much more—argue for the existence of God.

Now turn to 1 Thess. 1:9, for point number II: THE PERSONALITY OF GOD.

II. *1 Thess. 1:9*

The Bible reveals God as a personality. He is called “the living and true God”—One possessing self-consciousness and self-determination. His personality is shown in what He does, such as:

- (1) God loves. “God so loved the world” (*John 3:16*).
- (2) God hates. “These six *things* the **LORD** hates” (*Prov. 6:16 OT*).

(3) God cares. “He cares for you” (1 Pet. 5:7).

(4) God grieves. “He was grieved in His heart” (Gen. 6:6 OT).

Only a personality can love, hate, care, and grieve; therefore, God must be a living, eternal, and personal being.

Now turn to 1 John 4:8, for point number III: THE NATURE OF GOD.

III. 1 John 4:8

There are four definitions of God in the Bible. Since God cannot be defined, they are incomplete. However, they do throw light upon the nature of God. They are:

(1) “God is love” (verse 8). This is the nature of God in His divine compassion.

(2) “God is light” (1 John 1:5). This is the nature of God in His divine character; in Him there is no darkness.

(3) “God is a consuming fire” (Heb. 12:29). This is the nature of God in His divine holiness.

(4) “God is Spirit” (John 4:24). This is the nature of God in His divine essence.

The attributes of God reveal His nature. Do not think of His attributes as abstract, but as vital mediums through which His holy nature is unveiled—attributes ascribed to Him, such as:

(a) Life is ascribed to God (John 5:26).

(b) All knowledge is ascribed to God (Ps. 147:5 OT).

(c) All power is ascribed to God (Rev. 19:6).

(d) Filling the universe with His presence is ascribed to God (Ps. 139:7-10 OT).

God is everywhere present, but He is not in everything. If God were in everything, man could worship any object and he would be worshipping God. God is a spirit being. “And those who worship Him must worship in spirit and truth” (John 4:24).

Now turn to Eph. 2:8, 9, for point number IV: THE GRACE OF GOD.

IV. Eph. 2:8, 9

Grace is the love and mercy of God in action. Mercy is negative, and love is positive; both together mean grace. To show mercy in love is grace. God showed mercy in love when He sent His Son to bear our sins in His own body on the cross (John 3:16).

(1) The grace of God saves forever (Rom. 8:38, 39).

(2) The grace of God is unconditional; that is, we are not saved on the condition that we “hold out unto the end” or that we “fail not” or that we “do our best.” We are saved by the grace of God, apart from works.

(3) The grace of God is sufficient (2 Cor. 12:9).

(4) The grace of God makes no discrimination (Rev. 22:17).

(5) The grace of God justifies (Rom. 3:23, 24).

(6) The grace of God makes every believer an heir (Titus 3:7).

(7) The grace of God teaches the believer how to live (Titus 2:11, 12).

The grace of God is nothing less than the unlimited love of God expressed in the gift of His Son, our Savior. It is the undeserved love of God toward sinners.

Now turn to Matt. 3:16, 17, for point number V: *THE TRINITY OF GOD*.

V. Matt. 3:16, 17

By the Trinity of God we mean His tri-personal existence as Father, Son, and Holy Spirit—three distinct persons in one God.

- (1) The Father is recognized as God (*1 Pet. 1:2*) and is all the fullness of the Godhead invisible (*John 1:18*).
- (2) The Son is recognized as God (*Heb. 1:2*) and is all the fullness of the Godhead manifested in the flesh (*John 1:14*).
- (3) The Holy Spirit is recognized as God (*Acts 5:3, 4*) and is all the fullness of the Godhead acting upon man, convicting him of sin (*John 16:7-11*) and guiding the believer into all truth (*John 16:12-15*).
- (4) The doctrine of the Trinity is not explicit in the Old Testament, but is rather implied, “Then God said, ‘Let Us make man . . .’” (*Gen. 1:26 OT*).
- (5) The doctrine of the Trinity is revealed in the New Testament. In verses 16 and 17, we have Christ being baptized in water, the Father speaking from heaven, and the Holy Spirit descending as a dove. We are to baptize in the “name [not names] of the Father and of the Son and of the Holy Spirit” (*Matt. 28:19*).
- (6) Even creation implies the doctrine of the Trinity. In creation, we have space, matter, and time in one creation. In space, we have length, width, and height in one space. In matter, we have energy, motion, and phenomenon in one substance. In time, we have past, present, and future in one time. In man, we have body, soul, and spirit in one man (*1 Thess. 5:23*).
- (7) In the Holy Trinity, we have Father, Son, and Holy Spirit in one God.

Now return to Master Study Outlines for lesson number three.

Master Outline 3

JESUS CHRIST—THE SON OF GOD

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER THREE

Jesus Christ—The Son of God

Christianity differs from all religions, because it is more than a religion—it is the life of the Son of God made living in man. Christ is Christianity, and Christianity is Christ. He is the supreme subject of each book of the New Testament, and He fulfills all the promises of God in the Old Testament, from His incarnation to His Second Coming as “Lord of lords and King of kings” (Rev. 17:14). He is the God-man Christ Jesus in glory, exalted above all creatures, having “all authority ... in heaven and on earth” (Matt. 28:18).

During His earthly ministry, He claimed to be God incarnate (in human flesh). He is all that He claimed to be, or He is less than the least (Rev. 1:8). Before His claim can be denied, there are some things that must be accounted for:

His virgin birth;

His holy, sinless life;

His many miracles;

His vicarious death and His bodily resurrection.

I. THE DEITY OF JESUS CHRIST

II. THE HUMANITY OF JESUS CHRIST

III. THE VIRGIN BIRTH OF JESUS CHRIST

IV. THE DEATH OF JESUS CHRIST

V. THE RESURRECTION OF JESUS CHRIST

VI. THE ASCENSION AND SECOND COMING OF JESUS CHRIST

I. *John 1:1*

The deity of Jesus Christ, or His God nature, is well established in the New Testament. Some of the facts are:

(1) He is called God by the apostle John (verse 1).

(2) He is called God by the apostle Thomas (*John 20:28*).

(3) He is called God by God the Father (*Heb. 1:8*).

(4) He claimed to be God in that He was with the Father before creation (*John 17:5*).

(5) He claimed to be God in that He was before Abraham. “Abraham rejoiced to see My day . . .” (*John 8:51-59*).

(6) He received worship, and only God is to be worshiped (*Matt. 14:33*). Angels refused worship (*Rev. 22:8, 9*). Man refused worship (*Acts 10:25, 26*).

(7) He forgives sin (*Mark 2:5-11*). Only God can forgive sin.

(8) He is creator and maker of all things (*Col. 1:16*).

(9) He is sustainer of all things (*Heb. 1:3*). Only God can control the universe.

(10) He claimed to have “all authority . . . in heaven and on earth” (*Matt. 28:18*). Only God has all authority.

(11) He walked upon the blue waters of Galilee. The winds and the waves obeyed His command. He healed the sick and raised the dead. He gave sight to the blind and hearing to the deaf. He cast out demons and made the lame to walk. He turned water into wine and fed five thousand with the lunch of a lad.

Now turn to *Rom. 1:3, 4*, for point number II: *THE HUMANITY OF JESUS CHRIST*.

II. *Rom. 1:3, 4*

The humanity of Jesus Christ is seen in His human parentage (*Matt. 2:11*).

(1) He developed as a normal human being (*Luke 2:52*).

(2) He was subject to all the sinless infirmities of the human nature:

He hungered (*Matt. 4:2*). He was thirsty (*John 19:28*). He was weary (*John 4:6*). He wept (*John 11:35*). He was tempted (*Heb. 4:15*).

Jesus is man, and yet He is more than man. He is not God and man, but the God-man. He is God in human flesh. His two natures are bound together in such a way that the two natures become united in one person, having a single consciousness and will.

Now turn to *Luke 1:26-35*, for point number III: *THE VIRGIN BIRTH OF JESUS CHRIST*.

III. *Luke 1:26-35*

The virgin birth of Jesus Christ is without parallel in human history. It was by the virgin birth that God became man, one perfect person but two natures: one nature being that of Almighty God, the other being that of man—man without sin (*Heb. 4:15*). The union of the two natures became the God-man Christ Jesus.

(1) The first hint of the virgin birth is found in *Gen. 3:15 OT*. The One to defeat Satan was to be born of “the seed” of the woman. This is a biological miracle; there is no “seed” of the woman. From this, we are to understand that One was to be born of a woman without a human father (verses 34, 35).

(2) Isaiah prophesied that a “virgin shall conceive and bear a Son, and shall call His name Immanuel [God with us]”—(*Is. 7:14 OT*).

(3) Again Isaiah prophesied, saying, “For unto us a Child is born, Unto us a Son is given” (*Is. 9:6, 7 OT*). This means that God gave His only begotten Son who was with Him from eternity, and the Child Jesus was born of a virgin. God gave His Son “unto us.”

(4) According to prophecy, He was to be born in Bethlehem (*Mic. 5:2 OT*). Joseph with Mary went up to Bethlehem to be taxed and to fulfill prophecy (*Luke 2:1-7*).

Now turn to *Phil. 2:8*, for point number IV: *THE DEATH OF JESUS CHRIST*.

IV. Phil. 2:8

The death of Jesus Christ is mentioned more than 120 times in the New Testament and is spoken of many times by the prophets in the Old Testament.

- (1) The death of Jesus Christ was vicarious (*Matt. 20:28*). He was God's substitute for sinners (*2 Cor. 5:21*). On the cross, Christ was made sin for the sinner. By faith in Him, the sinner is made righteous with the righteousness of God.
- (2) The death of Jesus Christ was natural (*John 19:31-37*). By a natural death, we mean that His spirit and soul were separated from His body.
- (3) The death of Jesus Christ was unnatural (*Rom. 6:23*). By an unnatural death, we mean that since He was sinless, in that He "committed no sin" (*1 Pet. 2:22*)—had no sin (*1 John 3:5*)—"knew no sin" (*2 Cor. 5:21*)—before He could die, He had to be "made sin for us." Therefore, His death was unnatural.
- (4) The death of Jesus Christ was preternatural (*Rev. 13:8*). By this, we mean that the death of Jesus Christ was not an afterthought with God; it was the forethought of God.
- (5) The death of Jesus Christ was supernatural (*John 10:17, 18*). Jesus said, "No one takes [life] from Me." Then He said, "I lay it down of Myself [supernaturally]." "I have power to take it again [supernaturally]." This He did on the cross, and three days and three nights later, He took life up again when He arose from the dead. Only God in the form of man could die a vicarious, natural, unnatural, preternatural, and supernatural death.

Now turn to *Matt. 28:1-20*, for point number V: *THE RESURRECTION OF JESUS CHRIST*.

V. Matt. 28:1-20

Jesus said, "I am the resurrection and the life" (*John 11:25*). The resurrection of Jesus Christ was the doctrine of every disciple, the faith of every true believer, the courage of every martyr, the theme of every sermon, and the power of every evangelist.

Luke tells us that we have "many infallible proofs" of His resurrection (*Acts 1:3*). Let us look at some of these "infallible proofs" according to eye witnesses:

- (1) After His resurrection He appeared first to Mary Magdalene (*John 20:11-18*).
- (2) He appeared to the women returning from the tomb (*Matt. 28:5-10*).
- (3) Then He appeared to Peter (*Luke 24:34*).
- (4) To the Emmaus disciples (*Luke 24:13-31*).
- (5) To the apostles, Thomas not present (*Luke 24:36-43*).
- (6) Again to the apostles, Thomas present (*John 20:24-29*).
- (7) To the seven by the Sea of Tiberias (*John 21:1-23*).
- (8) To over five hundred brethren (*1 Cor. 15:6*).
- (9) He was seen of James (*1 Cor. 15:7*).
- (10) He was seen again by the eleven apostles (*Matt. 28:16-20*; also *Acts 1:3-12*).
- (11) He was seen of Stephen, the first martyr (*Acts 7:55*).
- (12) He was seen of Paul on his way to Damascus (*Acts 9:3-6*; also *1 Cor. 15:8*).

Many of these eye witnesses died martyrs' deaths because they preached the resurrection of Jesus Christ. They were glad to die for a living Christ. They had the "infallible proofs."

When Jesus was arrested in the Garden of Gethsemane, all of His disciples "forsook Him and fled" (*Matt. 26:56*). From this time until after His resurrection, the disciples lived in fear. They did not believe that He would rise from the dead (*John 20:9*). Had Jesus not come from the dead, the cross would have been the end of Christianity. After the death of Jesus, we see His disciples dejected, discouraged, and defeated. The death of Jesus meant but one thing to them: the end. How do we account for the great change that came into their lives three days and three nights later? The only logical explanation is that they had the "infallible proofs" that He had risen from the dead, and was alive forevermore. They saw Him, talked with Him, touched Him, and ate with Him.

Now look at some "infallible proofs" according to circumstantial evidence:

- (1) The change that came into the lives of the disciples after the Resurrection—from fear to unlimited courage. They rejoiced in persecution (*Acts 5:40-42*). They chose death, with faith in the resurrected Christ, rather than to deny that faith and be delivered (*Heb. 11:35*).
- (2) The early church began to worship on the first day of the week, the day of the Resurrection. It was not a law—it was spontaneous (*Acts 20:7*). For almost two thousand years, the church has worshiped on the first day. For the Christian, every Sunday is Easter.
- (3) The early Christians went everywhere with the word of the Resurrection (*Acts 8:1-4*).
- (4) The empty tomb—for if Jesus is not alive, what happened to His body? The Roman guards were paid to say, "His disciples came at night and stole Him away while we slept" (verses 12, 13). First, the disciples lacked the courage. Had the disciples stolen His body, then how do you account for the fact that they all suffered, and most of them died martyrs' deaths? In the face of death, one of them would have revealed the hiding place of the "stolen body" to save his own life. Second, no one was ever arrested or tried for stealing the body of Jesus. It is evident that the governing officials did not believe the story of the guards. Third, the guards could have been put to death for sleeping while on watch. Fourth, if they were asleep, how could they have known that it was the disciples who "stole" the body? Fifth, had the enemies of Jesus moved the body, they could have produced it and brought a quick end to Christianity; and they would have!
- (5) The linen clothes found in the empty tomb are proof of the Resurrection (*John 20:1-10*). Since Jesus had been dead three days and nights, neither friend nor foe stealing the body would have removed the linen clothes from Him. When John saw the linen clothes and recognized that they were folded the same as when they were wrapped about the body, he knew that a miracle had taken place. Jesus came out of the clothes, and they collapsed without disturbing the folds. They were left in the empty tomb as "infallible proof"; and when John saw and understood, he believed that Jesus had come from the dead.

Now turn to Acts 1:9-11, for point number VI: THE ASCENSION AND SECOND COMING OF JESUS CHRIST.

VI. Acts 1:9-11

After forty days of instructing His disciples, the risen Christ ascended on high and is seated at the right hand of the Father (*Heb. 10:12*). Two men brought the message of His second coming to the apostles: “This *same* Jesus, who was taken up from you into heaven, will so come in like manner as you saw Him go into heaven.” The message of the second coming of Jesus is so important that it is mentioned over three hundred times in the New Testament.

- (1) He is coming with His church to be with Him (*1 Thess. 4:16, 17*; also *John 14:1-6*).
- (2) He is coming to judge the nations (*Matt. 25:31-46*).
- (3) He is coming to save Israel (*Rom. 11:25, 26*).
- (4) He is coming to sit upon the throne of David (*Luke 1:31-33*; also *Is. 9:6, 7 OT*).
- (5) He is coming to bring righteous government to this earth (*Heb. 1:8*). Jesus Christ is coming back to this earth again. “Even so, come, Lord Jesus!” (*Rev. 22:20*).

Now return to Master Study Outlines for lesson number four.

Master Outline 4

THE HOLY SPIRIT

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER FOUR

The Holy Spirit

The Holy Spirit is God, and is equal to the Father and the Son. Don't ever speak of Him as "It" or refer to Him as "an influence." He is God the Holy Spirit, and is set forth in the Bible as being distinct from the Father and the Son. In the Genesis account of creation, He is seen actively engaged in the work of creation, along with the Father and the Son. In the Old Testament, He came upon men to empower them for service; but, when they were disobedient, He departed from them.

When David sinned against the Lord, he prayed, "And do not take Your Holy Spirit from me" (Ps. 51:11 OT). In the New Testament, after Pentecost, we see the Holy Spirit indwelling the believer, never to leave him, filling and empowering him for service. The study of the person and work of the Holy Spirit is of utmost importance. A scriptural understanding of God the Holy Spirit will make you a better Christian and servant of God.

- I. THE DEITY OF THE HOLY SPIRIT
 - II. THE EMBLEMS OF THE HOLY SPIRIT
 - III. SINS AGAINST THE HOLY SPIRIT
 - IV. THE WORK OF THE HOLY SPIRIT
 - V. THE FRUIT OF THE HOLY SPIRIT
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I. Acts 5:3, 4

In dealing with Ananias, Peter revealed the deity of the Holy Spirit when he said, "Ananias, why has Satan filled your heart to lie to the Holy Spirit . . . You have not lied to men but to God." In this Scripture it is very clear that the Holy Spirit is God, and He is co-equal, co-eternal, and co-existent with the Father and the Son. His deity is also set forth in that He possesses divine attributes:

- (1) He is everywhere present in the universe (*Ps. 139:7-10 OT*).
- (2) He has all power (*Luke 1:35*).
- (3) He has all knowledge (*1 Cor. 2:10, 11*).
- (4) He is eternal (*Heb. 9:14*).

His deity is revealed in that His name is coupled in equality with the name of the Father and the Son:

- (1) In the baptism of the believer (*Matt. 28:19*).
- (2) In the apostolic benediction (*2 Cor. 13:14*).

His deity is seen in relation to the life and ministry of Jesus Christ:

- (1) Jesus was conceived by the Holy Spirit (*Luke 1:35*).
- (2) He was anointed by the Holy Spirit for service (*Acts 10:38*).
- (3) He was led by the Holy Spirit (*Matt. 4:1*).
- (4) He was crucified in the power of the Holy Spirit (*Heb. 9:14*).

(5) He was raised from the dead by the power of the Holy Spirit (*Rom. 8:11*).

(6) Jesus gave commandments to the apostles and the church through the Holy Spirit (*Acts 1:2*).

If Jesus needed to depend solely upon the Holy Spirit during His life and ministry here on the earth, can we afford to do less?

Now turn to *Luke 3:16*, for point number II: *THE EMBLEMS OF THE HOLY SPIRIT*.

II. *Luke 3:16*

It is often difficult to impart truth by the use of words. Frequently they reveal only a half-truth, leaving the other half hidden. The writers of the Bible used certain emblems when unfolding the mysteries of the Holy Spirit, because they illustrate more about Him than volumes can contain. They are:

(1) Fire as an emblem (*verse 16*). Fire speaks of His consuming, purifying power in the life of the believer (*Acts 2:3*; also *Is. 6:1-7 OT*).

(2) Wind as an emblem (*John 3:8*). Wind speaks of His hidden depth in His mighty regenerating power.

(3) Water as an emblem (*John 7:37-39*). Water speaks of His power to fill the believer to overflowing with spiritual life.

(4) Seal as an emblem (*Eph. 1:13*). Seal speaks of His ownership of the believer; it is a finished, eternal transaction.

(5) Oil as an emblem (*Acts 10:38*). Oil speaks of His power to anoint for service.

(6) Dove as an emblem (*Mark 1:10*). The dove speaks of His gentle, tender, peaceful nature. We may know “the peace of God, which surpasses all understanding” (*Phil. 4:7*) only when fully surrendered to God.

Now turn to *Matt. 12:31, 32* for point number III: *SINS AGAINST THE HOLY SPIRIT*.

III. *Matt. 12:31, 32*

This is a solemn study, because the Holy Spirit is God and can be sinned against by both the believer and the unbeliever. May He help you search your heart as you consider:

(1) The sin of blaspheming the Holy Spirit (above verses 31, 32). This sin is committed by unbelievers. It is often called the “unpardonable sin.” It has no forgiveness. It was committed by the enemies of Jesus when they accused Him of casting out demons by the power of Satan (*Matt. 12:24*) when Jesus cast them out by the “Spirit of God” (*Matt. 12:28*).

(2) The sin of resisting the Holy Spirit (*Acts 7:51*). This sin is committed by the unbeliever when rejecting Jesus Christ as Savior and Lord.

(3) The sin of grieving the Holy Spirit (*Eph. 4:30-32*). This sin is committed by believers. He is grieved by us unless He controls our lives to the glory of Jesus Christ.

(4) The sin of quenching the Holy Spirit (*1 Thess. 5:19*). This sin is committed by Christians when known sin is allowed to go unconfessed (*1 John 1:9*; also *Is. 59:1, 2 OT*).

(5) The sin of lying to the Holy Spirit (*Acts 5:1-11*). The sin of Ananias and Sapphira was deception, born in jealousy. They tried to mock God (*Gal. 6:7*). The Holy Spirit can be sinned against, because He is God.

Now turn to *John 16:7-14*, for point number IV: *THE WORK OF THE HOLY SPIRIT*.

IV. John 16:7-14

In instructing His disciples, regarding the coming of the Holy Spirit, Jesus said, “. . . for if I do not go away, the Helper will not come to you; but if I depart, I will send Him to you. And when He has come, He will . . .”:

- (1) Convict men of the sin of unbelief (verse 9).
- (2) Convict men that Jesus is the righteousness of God (verse 10; also *Rom. 10:3, 4*).
- (3) Convict men that the power of Satan has been broken (verse 11).
- (4) Regenerate the believer (*John 3:5*; also *Titus 3:5*).
- (5) Indwell the believer (*1 Cor. 6:19, 20*).
- (6) Seal the believer (*Eph. 1:13, 14*).
- (7) Baptize the believer (*Acts 1:5*; also *1 Cor. 12:13*).
- (8) Infill the believer (*Eph. 5:18*).
- (9) Empower the believer (*Acts 1:8*).
- (10) Lead the believer (*Gal. 5:16-18*).
- (11) Administer spiritual gifts to the believer (*1 Cor. 12:1-11*).

The Holy Spirit came on the day of Pentecost, to remain with the church until it is complete and presented to the Lord Jesus at His coming. Just as Jesus Christ finished the work He came to do in the flesh, so the Holy Spirit will finish the work He came to do in the church.

Now turn to *Gal. 5:22, 23*, for point number V: *THE FRUIT OF THE HOLY SPIRIT*.

V. Gal. 5:22, 23

“The fruit of the Spirit is love.” Only as we live in love can we fulfill the will of God in our lives. The believer must become love-inspired, love-mastered, and love-driven (*2 Cor. 5:14*). Without the fruit of the Spirit (love), we are just a religious noise (*1 Cor. 13:1*).

“The fruit of the Spirit is love,” and it is manifested in joy, peace, long-suffering, kindness, goodness, faithfulness, gentleness, and self-control:

- (1) Joy is love’s strength.
- (2) Peace is love’s security.
- (3) Longsuffering is love’s patience.
- (4) Kindness is love’s conduct.
- (5) Goodness is love’s character.
- (6) Faithfulness is love’s confidence.
- (7) Gentleness is love’s humility.
- (8) Self-control is love’s victory.

“Against such there is no law.”

A Holy Spirit-controlled man needs no law to cause him to live a righteous life. The secret of a Spirit-controlled life is found in dedication to God (*Rom. 12:1, 2*). Put your all on the altar, and the Holy Spirit will fill your heart

with the love of God (*Rom. 5:5*).

Now return to Master Study Outlines for lesson number five.

Master Outline 5

SIN

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER FIVE

Sin

In considering the question of sin, we are faced with two startling facts.

The first fact is that man makes so little of sin. To some, it is an illusion—a religious mirage—the invention of some fanatic. It is denied, joked about, and laughed at by man. Many who believe sin to be a fact continue in it with little thought of its penalty.

The second fact is that God makes so much of sin. God said, “The soul who sins shall die” (Ezek. 18:20 OT). “The wages of sin is death” (Rom. 6:23). All sins are an abomination to God (Prov. 6:16-19 OT), and He hates those who work iniquity (Ps. 5:5 OT). Moses said, “... All who behave unrighteously, are an abomination to the Lord your God” (Deut. 25:16 OT). Sin is an evil force. Its presence cannot be escaped in this life, but it can be overcome by the power of God.

I. THE ORIGIN OF SIN

II. WHAT IS SIN?

III. HOW SIN ENTERED INTO THE WORLD

IV. THE RESULTS OF SIN

V. GOD’S REMEDY FOR SIN

I. *Jude 1:6*

The origin of sin is one of the mysteries of the Bible. “The secret *things* belong to the **LORD** our God” (*Deut. 29:29 OT*). Its origin is one of the “secret things” that will remain wrapped in obscurity. Sin was first noted in the heart of Satan. He was created a perfect being, “. . . till iniquity was found in you” (*Ezek. 28:11-19 OT*). Satan fell from perfection when he exerted his will above the will of God. Five times he said, “I will” (*Is. 14:12-17 OT*). It was his will over God’s will—this is sin. It is believed that Satan, when first created, was the ruler of this earth (*Gen. 1:1 OT*), and that he fell through self-will; and at his fall, the earth “was without form, and void” (*Gen. 1:2 OT*). Isaiah tells us that God “did not create [the earth] in vain” (*Is. 45:18 OT*). He did not create it a chaos. The earth was a perfect creation in *Gen. 1:1 OT*. Something happened that caused a catastrophe and the earth became “without form, and void” (*Gen. 1:2 OT*), but it was not created thus. It is believed that some of the angels, along with Satan, sinned by leaving their first estate. This does not prove that Satan was the originator of sin, but it does reveal sin in the heart of Satan before God created man.

Now turn to 1 John 3:4, for point number II: WHAT IS SIN?

II. 1 John 3:4

It is impossible to deny the existence of sin, when the whole world is in conflict between good and evil. If sin were not a fact, there would be no crime; we would not need jails or prisons. We would need no locks on our doors, or vaults for our valuables. To some, sin is being indiscreet; or it is a weakness of the flesh. To others, it is the absence from good. To the so-called scholar, sin is ignorance; and to the evolutionist, it is the nature of the beast. The latest theory is that sin is a disease to be treated by science, because man is not a sinner—he is only sick. To others, sin is a form of selfishness, but God declares that:

- (1) Sin is lawlessness (above verse 4).
- (2) Sin is falling short of the glory of God (*Rom. 3:23*).
- (3) Sin is rebellion against God (*Is. 1:2 OT*).
- (4) Sin is unbelief; it makes God a liar (*1 John 5:10*).
- (5) Sin is going your own way, planning your life according to your own will, without seeking the will of God (*Is. 53:6 OT*).
- (6) All unrighteousness is sin (*1 John 5:17*).

Sin is a folly to deceive you, a force to destroy you, and a fact to condemn you. Sin is a volitional act of disobedience against the revealed will of God.

Now turn to *Rom. 5:12*, for point number III: *HOW SIN ENTERED INTO THE WORLD*.

III. *Rom. 5:12*

“. . . Through one man sin entered the world” (above verse 12). The fall of man is found in Genesis 3:1–24 (*OT*). When Adam sinned, his seed became corruptible (*1 Pet. 1:23*). Therefore, we are sinners, because we are born in sin (*Ps. 51:5 OT*). You do not have to teach children to be bad, but you do have to teach them to be good. You do not have to teach them to lie, but you do have to teach them to tell the truth. “Therefore, as through one man’s offense *judgment* came to all men, resulting in condemnation” (verse 18). According to the Word of God, all men are judged sinners; all are condemned already (*John 3:18*). “All have sinned” (*Rom. 3:23*). Sin entered the world through our first parents in the Garden of Eden, and “all have sinned” because all are sinners.

Man sins by choice, because he is a sinner by nature. Therefore, the dominion sin has over you is according to the delight you have in it.

Now turn to *Eph. 2:1*, for point number IV: *THE RESULTS OF SIN*.

IV. *Eph. 2:1*

“The wages of sin is death” (*Rom. 6:23*). As a result of man’s sin, there are three deaths. Keep in mind that death does not annihilate; it only separates. In the Garden of Eden, it separated man from God spiritually; this is spiritual death. In natural death, it separates the spirit and the soul from the body; this is physical death. In final death, it separates man from the mercy of God forever; this is eternal death.

- (1) The wages of sin is spiritual death. Just as sin separated man from God spiritually and drove him from the presence of God out of the Garden, so sin will separate you from God (*Is. 59:1, 2 OT*). The only way back to God is to confess your sins to Him (*1 John 1:9*) and forsake those sins (*Is. 55:7 OT*) that you may be restored to fellowship with Him.

(2) The wages of sin is physical death. Physical death is a result of sin. Death had no claim on man until man sinned. Now all die, because all are in sin. Death is universal; and, since we have a universal effect, we must have a universal cause, and that cause is universal sin. All men die—the good and the bad—the young and the old—and man will continue to die until death is destroyed by the Lord Jesus Christ (*1 Cor. 15:26*) and is swallowed up in victory (*1 Cor. 15:54-57*).

(3) The wages of sin is eternal death. “The soul who sins shall die” (*Ezek. 18:20 OT*). This is eternal separation from the love of God (*Rev. 20:14*). Once the soul passes beyond the portals of Hades, he is lost and lost forever. He will continue to exist, but without hope. He is damned and damned to all eternity. Eternal death is eternal separation from God (*Luke 16:19-31*).

Now turn to *2 Cor. 5:21*, for point number V: GOD’S REMEDY FOR SIN.

V. *2 Cor. 5:21*

Man, not willing to accept God’s remedy for his ruin, strives to bring about his own salvation by human means.

(1) He strives for self-righteousness, when he needs to be made the righteousness of God (verse 21; also *Is. 64:6 OT*).

(2) He strives to reform, when he needs to be regenerated (*Titus 3:5*).

(3) He strives to turn over a new leaf, when he needs a new life (*John 10:10*).

(4) He strives to be justified by the Law, when he needs to be justified by faith in the Lord Jesus Christ (*Gal. 2:16*).

(5) He strives to clean up the old man, when he needs to be made a new man in Christ (*Eph. 4:24*).

(6) He strives to be saved by good works, when he needs salvation by the grace of God (*Eph. 2:8, 9*).

The only remedy for the ruin of man is the Son of God, being made sin for us on the cross. The only way to receive this remedy is by faith in Him as personal Savior (*John 20:30, 31*).

Now return to Master Study Outlines for lesson number six.

Master Outline 6

JUDGMENTS

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER SIX

Judgments

In the Scriptures, we are instructed to “rightly [divide] the word of truth” (2 Tim. 2:15). This is most essential when studying the judgments. Do not endeavor to make all the judgments conform to the theory of one “general judgment.” The “general judgment” theory is the invention of religion and is not taught in the Word of God. There are five separate judgments revealed in the Bible, and they differ as to time, place, and purpose. Yet, they all have one thing in common: the Lord Jesus Christ is the judge (John 5:22).

Everyone—from Adam to the last man to be born on this earth—will stand before the Lord Jesus Christ to be judged.

In the first judgment, the sins of the believers have already been judged in Christ on the cross.

In the second judgment, the believer is to judge self, or be judged and disciplined by the Lord Jesus Christ.

In the third judgment, all believers must appear at the “judgment seat of Christ” where their works are to be judged.

In the fourth judgment, all nations are to be judged at the Second Coming of Christ.

In the fifth judgment, the wicked dead are to be judged at the great white throne.

- I. THE JUDGMENT OF THE BELIEVER’S SINS
- II. THE JUDGMENT OF THE BELIEVER’S SELF
- III. THE JUDGMENT OF THE BELIEVER’S WORKS
- IV. THE JUDGMENT OF THE NATIONS
- V. THE JUDGMENT OF THE WICKED

I. John 5:24

In the above verse, our Lord tells us that the believer “shall not come into judgment” (*Matt. 10:15*). Our sins were judged in Christ on Calvary and every believer “has passed from death into life.” This is present salvation. Christ paid for our sins. He was judged in the believer’s stead. The believer will not come into judgment because:

- (1) Jesus Christ paid the penalty, and on the grounds of His substitutional death, the believer is separated from his sins forever (*Ps. 103:12 OT*).
- (2) The sins of the believer have been “blotted out” and God has promised that He “will not remember your sins” (*Is. 43:25 OT*).
- (3) Our Lord suffered for our sins, “the just for the unjust,” that we might be saved and never come into judgment as sinners (*1 Pet. 3:18*).
- (4) The believer will never be condemned with the world, because Christ was condemned in his place. “For He made Him who knew no sin to be sin for us” (*2 Cor. 5:21*). Christ was made a curse for us on the cross, and “has redeemed us from the curse of the law” (*Gal. 3:13*). “He has appeared to put away sin by the sacrifice of Himself” (*Heb. 9:26*). The believer will not come into judgment because his sins have been

purged (*Heb. 1:3*).

Now turn to 1 Cor. 11:31, 32, for point number II: THE JUDGMENT OF THE BELIEVER'S SELF.

II. 1 Cor. 11:31, 32

The judgment of the believer's self is more than judging things in the believer's life. When the believer judges self, the good and the bad in his life come to light; and he will confess the bad (*1 John 1:9*) and forsake it (*Is. 55:7 OT*). However, it is not enough just to judge sin in the believer; he must judge self.

- (1) To judge self is to practice self-abnegation, for when the believer sees self as God sees him, he will renounce self. It is replacing the self-life with the Christ-life (*Col. 3:4*). Christ is the believer's life.
- (2) To judge self is to deny self. This is more than self-denial. Self-denial is denying one's self of the gratifications of the flesh. If we practice self-denial only, it is treating the symptom and not the cause. But when we deny self, we are attacking the cause, for in self (that is, in the flesh) "nothing good dwells" (*Rom. 7:18*). To deny self is to take up our cross and follow Christ (*Mark 8:34-38*).
- (3) To judge self is to lose the self-life and find the Christ-life (*Gal. 2:20*).
- (4) To judge self is to no longer be self-conscious, but become Christ-conscious (*Matt. 28:20*).
- (5) To judge self is to no longer be self-controlled, but to become Christ-controlled (*Acts 9:6*).
- (6) To judge self is to no longer practice self-esteem, but to esteem others better than self (*Phil. 2:3*). To judge self is to become selfless.

Now turn to 2 Cor. 5:10, for point number III: THE JUDGMENT OF THE BELIEVER'S WORKS.

III. 2 Cor. 5:10

The believer's works will be judged at the "judgment seat of Christ." The term "judgment seat of Christ" is found only twice in the Bible, but it is referred to many times. It is found in the above verse; also see *Rom. 14:10*. A careful reading of both verses with the context reveals that only believers will appear at the "judgment seat of Christ." Their works will be judged, not their sins, for we have already seen that the sins of the believer were judged in Christ on Calvary, and "There is therefore now no condemnation to those who are in Christ Jesus" (*Rom. 8:1*).

- (1) This judgment will take place "in the air," following the first resurrection. "The dead in Christ will rise first" (*1 Thess. 4:14-18*). There will be a thousand years between the resurrection of the saved and the unsaved (*Rev. 20:4, 5*), and there will be a thousand years between the "judgment seat of Christ" where only saved will appear and the "great white throne judgment" where only unsaved will appear.
- (2) At the judgment seat of Christ, the believer will give an account of himself to God. Therefore, we should look to our own works, and not judge the works of others (*Rom. 14:10-13*).
- (3) It is a most humbling thought to know that some day the believer will face all of his works—"good or bad." Some will be ashamed (*1 John 2:28*) and "suffer loss"—not the loss of salvation, but the loss of rewards (*1 Cor. 3:11-15*). So whatever you do, do it to the glory of God (*Col. 3:17*).

Now turn to Matt. 25:31-46, for point number IV: THE JUDGMENT OF THE NATIONS.

IV. Matt. 25:31-46

This judgment is not the judgment of the great white throne (*Rev. 20:11-15*). A careful comparison of the two judgments will establish the following facts:

- (1) The judgment of the nations will take place “when the Son of Man comes in His glory, . . . then He will sit on the throne of His glory.” The great white throne is never called “the throne of His glory” (*Rev. 20:11-15*).
- (2) At this judgment, He will judge the living nations (*Joel 3:11-16 OT*). At the white throne judgment, He will judge the wicked dead.
- (3) At this judgment, there will be no resurrection of the dead. At the great white throne, all the wicked dead are raised: “The sea gave up the dead who were in it, and Death and Hades delivered up the dead who were in them . . .” (*Rev. 20:13*).
- (4) At this judgment, the judge is God “the King” judging the living nations in His earthly kingdom. At the great white throne, the judge is God, judging only the wicked dead.
- (5) At this judgment, there are no books opened. At the great white throne, the “books were opened.”
- (6) At this judgment, there are three classes judged: “sheep”—the saved (*Rev. 7:9-17*); “goats”—the unsaved (*2 Thess. 1:7-10*); “tribes”—the elect of Israel (*Rev. 7:1-8*; also *Rom. 11:25-28*). At the great white throne, there is only one class: “the wicked dead.”
- (7) At this judgment, the King gives the kingdom to those who have eternal life. At the great white throne, there are no saved and no kingdom; they are all “cast into the lake of fire.”

Now turn to *Rev. 20:11-15*, for point number V: *THE JUDGMENT OF THE WICKED*.

V. Rev. 20:11-15

The great white throne judgment will follow the thousand-year reign of Christ. This is the final judgment, and only the wicked dead are to be judged. According to *Rev. 20:5*, the believers were resurrected a thousand years before this judgment, and their works were judged at the “judgment seat of Christ” (*2 Cor. 5:10*).

- (1) At this judgment, the wicked dead will seek a hiding place from the face of the Lord Jesus Christ, the judge. But there is no hiding place.
- (2) At this judgment, the “dead, great and small” will stand before God. But the greatness of the great will be of no value. “There is none who does good, no, not one” (*Rom. 3:12*).
- (3) At this judgment, the “book of life” will be opened. Why the “book of life” if there are no saved at this judgment? The wicked will be shown that God in His mercy provided space for them in the “Book of life,” so that they are without excuse (*Rom. 1:18-20*).
- (4) At this judgment, the dead will be judged “according to [their] works.” God is a just God; and since there are degrees of punishment in hell, some will be punished more than others (*Luke 12:42, 48*).
- (5) At this judgment, there will be no acquittal, no higher court to which the lost may appeal. It is lost forever; it is damned to all eternity, and that without hope. There is a Hades (*Luke 16:19-31*); and in Hades, there is no hope, no sympathy, no love; even the love of God does not extend beyond the portals of Hades.

Now return to Master Study Outlines for lesson number seven.

Notes (continued)

Master Outline 7

REWARDS

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER SEVEN

Rewards

There is a vast difference in the doctrine of salvation for the lost, and the doctrine of rewards for the saved. Salvation is “the gift of God, not of works” (Eph. 2:8, 9). Salvation is received by faith in the Lord Jesus Christ (John 3:36). Rewards are according to the works of the believer (Matt. 16:27).

A most revealing Scripture concerning rewards is found on 1 Cor. 3:8-15. First, every believer will be rewarded “according to his own labor” (verse 8), not for labor for salvation.

Second, “we are God’s fellow workers” (verse 9)—not for salvation, but for rewards.

Third, the believer is to build on the Lord Jesus Christ, “for no other foundation can anyone lay than that which is laid, which is Jesus Christ” (verse 11).

Fourth, the believer has a choice of two kinds of building materials: “gold, silver, precious stones”—this is building with eternal materials; or “wood, hay, straw”—this is building with temporal materials (verse 12) (2 Cor. 4:18).

The believer who builds on Christ with eternal materials, “gold, silver, precious stones,” shall receive a reward. The works of “wood, hay, straw,” will be destroyed at the “judgment seat of Christ,” and the believer will suffer loss—not the loss of salvation, but the loss of eternal reward.

Some believers will be ashamed at the “judgment seat of Christ” (1 John 2:28)—ashamed of their works of “wood, hay, straw.”

In the first year of my ministry, I sat at the bedside of a dying friend. As we talked of his homegoing, tears filled his eyes. Being young in the Lord, I thought he was afraid to die, and attempted to speak words of encouragement to him. He said, “I am not afraid to die; I am ashamed to die.” He went on to say that Christ was his Savior, but he had lived for self, and now had to meet the Lord Jesus Christ empty-handed. His life loomed up before him as “wood, hay, straw.” He was “saved so as by fire.”

Rewards are called “crowns” in the New Testament.

I. THE CROWN OF LIFE

II. THE CROWN IMPERISHABLE

III. THE CROWN OF REJOICING

IV. THE CROWN OF RIGHTEOUSNESS

V. THE CROWN OF GLORY

I. James 1:12

This reward could be called the lover's crown. Upon examination of the above verse, we discover that the believer finds strength to overcome temptation and endure trials, through the love of God. Paul said, "We also glory in tribulations." The question is, Do we today glory in tribulations? We can, only if the "love of God has been poured out in our hearts by the Holy Spirit" (*Rom. 5:3-5*). Without the love of God in the heart of the believer, trials can cause him to become bitter and critical and lose the "crown of life."

All believers have eternal life (*John 3:15, 16*), but not all believers will be rewarded with the "crown of life." This crown will be given to those who are "faithful until death" (*Rev. 2:10*). To receive the "crown of life," the believer must love the Lord more than his own life. "For whoever desires to save his life [live for self] will lose it, but whoever loses his life for My sake and the gospel's [live for Christ at all cost] will save it" (*Mark 8:35*). This reward will be given to those who live for Christ, and endure temptations, in the power of the love of God (*1 Cor. 10:13*).

Now turn to *1 Cor. 9:24-27*, for point number II: THE CROWN IMPERISHABLE.

II. 1 Cor. 9:24-27

Paul makes use of the Greek games to illustrate the spiritual race of the believer. They ran to win a "perishable crown, but we *for* an imperishable crown." No young man could contend in the games unless he was a Greek citizen, born of Greek parents. No unsaved person can participate in the services of the Lord for rewards; only the born of God are eligible (*John 3:3*).

Just as the athlete must deny himself many gratifications of the body, so the believer must say "I discipline my body and bring *it* into subjection" or he will become "disqualified." He will not lose his salvation, but he will lose the "imperishable crown."

The Greek games had hard and fast rules for all participants. The New Testament contains the rules for believers who would enter the spiritual race to win the "imperishable crown."

- (1) The believer must deny self of anything that would weigh him down and hold him back (*Heb. 12:1*).
- (2) The believer must keep his eyes fixed on Christ, and not look to the right or the left (*Heb. 12:2*).
- (3) The believer must find his strength in the Lord (*Eph. 6:10-18*).
- (4) The believer must place his all upon the altar of the Lord (*Rom. 12:1, 2*).
- (5) The believer must, by faith, refuse anything that would impede spiritual progress (*Heb. 11:24-29*).

Do not be a spiritual spectator. Enter the race and run to win the "imperishable crown."

Now turn to *1 Thess. 2:19, 20*, for point number III: THE CROWN OF REJOICING.

III. 1 Thess. 2:19, 20

The "crown of rejoicing" is the soul winner's crown. The greatest work you are privileged to do for the Lord is to bring others to a knowledge of Christ as personal Savior. The degree of your joy in heaven will be determined by the souls you have had a part in bringing to Christ. Paul tells the Thessalonian believers that they are his "hope, or joy, or crown of rejoicing" now and when Jesus comes.

- (1) It is wise to win souls to Christ (*Prov. 11:30 OT*).

- (2) It is a work against sin to win souls to Christ (*James 5:20*).
- (3) It is a cause for joy in heaven to win souls to Christ (*Luke 15:10*).
- (4) Every soul winner will shine as the stars forever (*Dan. 12:3 OT*).

How you can win souls to Christ:

Witness with your life; live that others may see Christ in you (*2 Cor. 3:2*; also *Gal. 2:20*).

Witness with your mouth, trusting the Holy Spirit to give power to the spoken word (*Acts 1:8*).

Witness by tithes and offerings that others may preach Christ, and you will have “fruit [reward] that abounds to your account” (*Phil. 4:15-17*; also *2 Cor. 9:6*).

God has promised that your labor will not be in vain in the Lord (*1 Cor. 15:58*). The soul winner will not rejoice alone—all of heaven will rejoice with him when he receives the “crown of rejoicing” (*John 4:36*).

Now turn to *2 Tim. 4:5-8*, for point number IV: *THE CROWN OF RIGHTEOUSNESS*.

IV. 2 Tim. 4:5-8

The “crown of righteousness” is a reward, and it is not to be confused with the “righteousness of God” which the believer receives when he becomes a Christian; for at that time, the believer is to “become the righteousness of God in Him” (*2 Cor. 5:21*). This saving righteousness is a gift to be accepted by the lost. The “crown of righteousness” is a reward to be earned by the saved. If the believer looks for, and loves the doctrine of the second coming of Christ, it will affect his whole life. Look at the dynamic impact this truth had on the life of the apostle Paul. He could say:

- (1) “I have fought the good fight” (verse 7; also *1 Cor. 15:32*). He fought a spiritual battle throughout his Christian life, and won. He never surrendered to the enemies of righteousness (*Eph. 6:12*).
- (2) “I have finished the race.” He had a race to run. And he did not detour the hard places; neither did he look back (*Luke 9:61, 62*). He finished his race with his eyes fixed on Christ (*Phil. 1:6*).
- (3) “I have kept the faith.” He preached the “whole counsel of God”—never betraying any of the great doctrines (*Acts 20:24-31*). The apostle looked ahead to the “judgment seat of Christ” where the “crown of righteousness” will be given to those “who have loved His appearing.” How important it is for the believer to look with a heart of love for the second coming of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ, that he may receive the “crown of righteousness” (verse 8).

Now turn to *1 Pet. 5:2-4*, for point number V: *THE CROWN OF GLORY*.

V. 1 Pet. 5:2-4

The “crown of glory” is a special reward for the faithful, obedient, God-called pastor. He will receive this reward when the “Chief Shepherd appears.” It is eternal; it “does not fade away.” Every believer may share in the pastor’s “crown of glory.” “He who receives a prophet in the name of a prophet shall receive a prophet’s reward” (*Matt. 10:41*). Support your faithful, God-called pastor by praying for him and encouraging him in the work of the Lord. Undergird his ministry with God’s tithes and your offerings (*Mal. 3:10 OT*), giving freely of your time to the service of the Lord. And God will reward you for supporting His chosen servant by allowing you to share in your pastor’s reward. The pastor will earn this “crown of glory” by:

- (1) Feeding the church. He is to proclaim the Word of God without fear or favor; and, when necessary, he will “convince, rebuke, exhort, with all longsuffering and teaching” (*2 Tim. 4:2-5*).
- (2) Taking the spiritual oversight of the church. The pastor is responsible to God for the message preached to his people. No pastor should preach to please the people; he is to please his Lord (*Gal. 1:10*).
- (3) Being an example to the church. He is not to serve for the reward of money. Yet, the church is responsible to care for his every material need (*1 Tim. 5:18*). He is to be a spiritual leader, and not a dictator. He is to walk with God by faith. “And when the Chief Shepherd appears, you will receive the crown of glory that does not fade away” (*1 Pet. 5:4*).

Now return to Master Study Outlines for lesson number eight.

Master Outline 8

THE CHURCH

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER EIGHT

The Church

Jesus said, “I will build My church” (Gk. *ecclesia*) (Matt. 16:18). The word *ecclesia* in the New Testament is used to designate any assembly whether it be political (Acts 19:39), Christian (Eph. 1:22, 23), or national (Acts 7:38). It means a “called-out assembly” or “congregation.” God called Israel out of Egypt; they congregated in the wilderness; they were “the church in the wilderness.” Today, God calls the saved out of the world to congregate in worship. This is the church in the world, in it but not of it.

Unlike the church in the wilderness, the church that Jesus is building will never cease. He said, “The gates of Hades shall not prevail against it.” His church is not synonymous with Christendom. It is in Christendom in the same way in which it is in the world, in it but not of it. Christendom is made up of those who profess to be Christians, but they know not Christ as a personal Savior (Matt. 7:21-23, also, 2 Tim. 3:5 and Titus 1:16). Only blood-washed, born again, Spirit-baptized believers constitute the church that Jesus is building. It is called a:

- (1) Mystery (Eph. 3:3-10).
- (2) Body (1 Cor. 12:12-31).
- (3) Building (Eph. 2:10-22).
- (4) Bride (2 Cor. 11:2).

I. THE CHURCH: ITS FOUNDATION

II. THE CHURCH: ITS HEAD

III. THE CHURCH: ITS ORGANIZATION

IV. THE CHURCH: ITS DISCIPLINE

V. THE CHURCH: ITS WORSHIP AND WORK

VI. THE CHURCH: ITS POWER

VII. THE CHURCH: ITS FUTURE

I. **Matt. 16:13-18**

“On this rock I will build My church.” Leading up to this declaration He asked His disciples, “Who do men say that I, the Son of Man, am?” They answered naming some of the prophets. Then He said to them, “But who do you say that I am?” Peter answered, “You are the Christ, the Son of the living God” (verse 16). In verse 13 Jesus spoke of Himself as the “Son of Man.” Now Peter speaks of Him as the “Son of the living God.” Jesus blessed Peter and said that this great truth came from God the Father. Again He said to Peter, “You are Peter (Petros, a little rock), and upon this rock (Petra, a big rock) I will build My church.” Jesus did not say that He would build His church upon Peter, but upon Himself, the Rock of Ages.

Simon Peter called Jesus the “living stone,” the chief “cornerstone,” a “stone of stumbling,” and a “rock of offense.” He spoke of all believers, including himself, as “living stones.” Christ is the foundation and believers are the building stones (*1 Pet. 2:1-10*).

Paul speaks of Christ as the foundation of the Apostles and Prophets (*Eph. 2:19-22*). He also said, “For no other foundation can anyone lay than that which is laid, which is Jesus Christ” (*1 Cor. 3:11*). Although the church was a mystery in the Old Testament, Isaiah said, “Therefore thus says the Lord **GOD**: ‘Behold, I lay in Zion a stone for a foundation, a tried stone, a precious cornerstone, a sure foundation’” (*Is. 28:16 OT*). Christ is the sure foundation of His church and all believers are little building stones built into a Holy Temple in the Lord.

Now turn to Col. 1:18, for point number II: THE CHURCH: ITS HEAD.

II. Col. 1:18

“He is the head of the body, the church.” Christ is the foundation, cornerstone, and head of His church. He is head of the local church, and He is head of the church in its all-inclusive broader sense, including all born again, blood-washed, Spirit-baptized believers in heaven and earth.

The church is more than a religious organization; it is an organism, with Christ as the living head. It is alive with the life of Christ made living in each member (*1 Cor. 12:1-31*). Let us examine briefly the church and observe its role as the body of Christ.

- (1) The members of the body are given spiritual gifts according to the will of the Holy Spirit (verses 1-11).
- (2) The unity of the body is seen in its many members with different operations all related and coordinated under one Head (verse 12).
- (3) All are baptized by one Spirit into one body (verse 13).
- (a) There is one Holy Spirit.
- (b) There is one Holy Spirit baptism.
- (c) There is one body (the church).

This is the church in its broadest sense. You cannot join this church. The only way to become a member of His body is to be spiritually born (*John 3:1-7*) and be baptized into it by the Holy Spirit.

- (4) The members differ one from the other, yet they function as one in the will of God (*1 Cor. 12:14-18*).
- (5) The least or weakest member is necessary for the proper function of the whole body (verses 22, 23).
- (6) If one member suffers, the whole body suffers; if one is honored, all are honored (verse 26).
- (7) The members are to desire the best spiritual gifts and minister in love (verse 31).

The Lord Jesus Christ has never delegated His authority to anyone, whether he be pope, pastor, deacon, or the majority of the congregation. He is “head over all *things* to the church” (*Eph. 1:22*), the only absolute and final authority.

Now turn to Titus 1:4, 5, for point number III: THE CHURCH: ITS ORGANIZATION.

III. Titus 1:4, 5

There is scriptural evidence of some organization in the local church from its inception. It was a definite and permanent organized congregation, but not as we know it today.

Paul left Titus in Crete to organize the believers into local church bodies and to “set in order the things that are lacking, and appoint elders in every city” (verse 5).

The local New Testament church is a microcosm of the complete body of Christ in heaven and earth. The word “church” is used over one hundred times in the New Testament, and the great majority of the references refer to the local congregation.

Organization in the local church is seen in:

(1) Its Officers.

He gave to the church “apostles” (this refers to the Twelve; there are no apostles in the church today), “prophets” (we have no prophets and have not had since the last book of the New Testament was written), “evangelists” (the evangelist will serve the church until Jesus comes), and “pastors and teachers” (*Eph. 4:11, 12*). Pastors and teachers are local ministers; the apostles, prophets, and evangelists are ministers at large.

Another officer is the deacon. His qualifications are set forth in First Timothy (*1 Tim. 3:8-13*). Deacons are never called a board in the Scriptures. They are not to run the church; they are ordained to assist the pastor by ministering to the saints (*Acts 6:1-7*).

(2) Its Membership Records.

The church must have kept some records of its members. The Book of Acts tells us that there were about 120 in the upper room. The account (*Acts 1:15-26*) reads like the average local church business meeting. Simon Peter is the pastor; he takes the lead and gives direction in choosing one to take the place of Judas. “And they cast their lots” and Matthias was chosen to be an apostle. On the day of Pentecost about 3,000 were added to the body of Christ by Holy Spirit baptism (*1 Cor. 12:13*) and to the local church in Jerusalem by water baptism (*Acts 2:41*). Again the records show another 5,000 added (*Acts 4:4*). The Scriptures tell us that “the Lord added to the church daily those who were being saved” (*Acts 2:47*).

(3) Its Ordinances.

(a) Baptism (baptize means to immerse). The Lord commands the believer to be baptized. This is the believer’s first opportunity to obey his Lord and Savior Jesus Christ. In the early church no one ever questioned water baptism; they obeyed (*Matt. 28:18-20*; also *Rom. 6:1-4*). Baptism does not save. It is a picture of your faith in His death, burial, and resurrection. It is faith in Christ that saves (*John 3:36*) and the Ordinance of Baptism that identifies the believer with the risen Savior.

(b) The Lord’s Supper. There is no saving power in the Lord’s Supper. It is a memorial. The bread is symbolical of His broken body and the wine of His shed blood for the remission of our sins. Baptism identifies the believer with Christ in His death, burial, and resurrection; and the Lord’s Supper is a memorial to be observed by the believer to “proclaim the Lord’s death till He comes” (*1 Cor. 11:23-34*).

Now turn to *Matt. 18:15-17*, for point number IV: *THE CHURCH: ITS DISCIPLINE*.

IV. *Matt. 18:15-17*

This is the most difficult and necessary function of the local assembly, and its importance cannot be exaggerated. “Do you not know that a little leaven leavens the whole lump? Therefore purge out the old leaven” (*1 Cor. 5:6, 7*). Leaven in the Scripture is always a type of evil. The church is to purge out any evil in its membership. The motive for disciplining a brother is love (*1 John 4:7-11*). The goal is to restore him to fellowship with his Lord and the church.

“If your brother sins against you.”

(1) The first step is to be taken by the one sinned against. He is to go to his brother alone, not seeking revenge or self-justification, but to gain his brother.

(2) If he does not repent, the second step is to take one or two believers and go to him again.

(3) If he will not hear the two or three, the third step is take it to the church.

A good example of church discipline is reported in Paul's letters to the church at Corinth. He used strong words calling upon the church to discipline a member for fornication. He wrote, "*Put away from yourselves the evil person*" (1 Cor. 5:1-13). In his second letter to the Corinthian church we learn that the man repented and was restored to the fellowship of God's people. Now Paul writes, "Forgive and comfort *him* . . . reaffirm *your* love to him" (2 Cor. 2:3-11). The attitude of the church toward a repenting brother should always be that of forgiveness in love.

Now turn to Matt. 28:16-20, for point number V: THE CHURCH: ITS WORSHIP AND WORK.

V. Matt. 28:16-20

First, the church: its worship. "When they saw Him, they worshiped Him" (verse 17). To worship is to bow down in awe; to pay divine honors to God in humble, reverent homage. There are three essentials in worship; they are:

(1) Faith, "The people believed; . . . then they bowed their heads and worshiped" (Ex. 4:31 OT).

(2) Spirit, "Those who worship Him must worship in spirit and truth" (John 4:23, 24). Spiritual worship is worship directed by the indwelling Holy Spirit (Phil. 3:3).

(3) Truth, "Those who worship Him must worship in spirit and truth" (John 4:24). Jesus Christ is truth, "I am the way, the truth, and the life" (John 14:6). Therefore, there can be no pretense or hypocrisy in true worship. The parable of the Pharisee and the publican illustrates true and false worship (Luke 18:9-14). The publican worshiped in truth and he went home justified. The Pharisee worshiped in religious pride and he went home rejected.

Second, the church: its work. "For from you the word of the Lord has sounded forth" (1 Thess. 1:8). The church in Thessalonica did the work of the Lord so well that the apostles did not have to evangelize Macedonia and Achaia. The church shared its faith with the lost, and after all, that is the main work of the church. In this way, "for two years . . . all who dwelt in Asia heard the word of the Lord Jesus, both Jews and Greeks" (Acts 19:8-10). All of Asia did not journey to Ephesus to hear Paul. It is evident that the believers went everywhere sharing the gospel. The work of the church is to go with the gospel, because:

(1) The church is commissioned to work (verses 18-20).

(2) The church is to work with Christ (2 Cor. 6:1) and the Holy Spirit (Acts 5:32).

(3) The church is to work with Christ in His field (the world) (Matt. 13:36-43; also Mark 16:15).

(4) The need for the church to work is great (John 4:35).

(5) The time for the church to work is now (2 Cor. 6:2).

(6) The church is to work until Jesus comes to judge the works of the saints (2 Cor. 5:10).

(7) The church will be rewarded for its works (1 Cor. 3:9-15). God's program for the local church is COME AND WORSHIP, GO AND WORK (witness) (Acts 8:1-4).

Now turn to Acts 1:8, for point number VI: THE CHURCH: ITS POWER.

VI. Acts 1:8

On the day of Pentecost the church received power to evangelize the world. When the hundred and twenty came down from the upper room, they came in the dynamics of the Holy Spirit. It was a spiritual phenomenon issuing forth in joyful ecstasy and miracle-working power, resulting in conviction of sin, “repentance toward God and faith toward our Lord Jesus Christ” (Acts 20:21). Some were empowered for special service, but all received power to witness.

The real power of the church is not found in:

- (1) Modern buildings or unique methods of preaching and teaching.
- (2) Its great wealth or how that wealth is used.
- (3) The church’s prominence or popularity. The Laodicean church was the first bragging congregation (Rev. 3:14-22), but not the last.

They said, “We are rich.” God said they were poor. They said, “We are wealthy.” God said they were wretched. They said, “We do not need anything.” God said they needed everything. They said, “We are busy in the church.” God said they were miserable. They said, “We have a vision.” God said they were blind. They said, “We are clothed in fine garments.” God said they were naked. They said, “We are satisfied.” God said they made Him sick.

You can always recognize a Holy Spirit-empowered church. The evidence is obvious; they have power to:

- (1) Evangelize: They share their faith with the lost and souls are saved. Evangelism is the only way to make full proof of your ministry (2 Tim. 4:5). When a church is not involved in winning souls, it grieves the Holy Spirit and is void of power.
- (2) Reproduce: Souls are born into the family of God by incorruptible seed which is the Word of God (1 Pet. 1:23). The Spirit-filled believer sows the seed; this is evangelism. The Holy Spirit hovers over the seed, convicting and leading the lost to repentance. This is the spiritual birth.
- (3) Change: people (Acts 2:37-41); places (Acts 5:28); and things (Matt. 17:20, 21).
- (4) Turn the world upside down (Acts 17:6).

This is the power that filled the upper room congregation on the day of Pentecost. That power is with the believer today in the person of the Holy Spirit. He is the power of the church.

Now turn to 1 Thess. 4:16, 17, for point number VII: THE CHURCH: ITS FUTURE.

VII. 1 Thess. 4:16, 17

The true church of Jesus Christ has a glorious, victorious future in the world, in the air, in the kingdom, and in eternity; it cannot fail. “The gates of Hades shall not prevail against it” (Matt. 16:18).

- (1) The future of the church in the world.

At Pentecost the Holy Spirit set the course for the church as it journeys from the upper room to the Rapture. It is to:

- (a) Wage war (Eph. 6:10-18).
- (b) Run a race (Heb. 12:1, 2).
- (c) Work in love (1 Cor. 3:9).

The church of Jesus Christ will emerge triumphant for “we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us” (*Rom. 8:35-39*). The church cannot fail because Christ is its head, the Holy Spirit is its power, and the Word of God is its guide.

(2) The future of the church in the air.

We shall be caught up (verse 17). Caught up:

(a) In our incorruptible bodies (*1 Cor. 15:42-44*).

(b) To meet the Lord in the heavens and for the great majority of the church to see Him in His resurrected body for the first time (*1 John 3:2*).

(c) That our works may be judged at the judgment seat of Christ (*2 Cor. 5:10*). This is the bema judgment.

(d) That we may be rewarded or suffer loss of reward (*1 Cor. 3:11-15*).

(3) The future of the church in the kingdom.

(a) The twelve apostles will sit on thrones and judge the twelve tribes of Israel (*Matt. 19:28*).

(b) All who overcome the evils of Christendom (Laodicea) will sit with Christ on His Kingdom Throne (*Rev. 3:21*).

(c) We shall reign with Him a thousand years (*Rev. 20:4-6*).

(4) The future of the church in eternity.

After the kingdom reign of one thousand years there will be “a new heaven and a new earth” (*Rev. 21:1*). The earth will be restored to its original, created state (*Gen. 1:1 OT*). God’s earthly people Israel will inherit the new earth (*Ex. 32:13 OT*).

The church, His bride, will remain in His presence forever. If in His human form He is in the new heaven or the new earth, we will be with Him, to see Him, to serve Him, and to worship Him. He will continue to bestow upon His bride the riches of His eternal grace (*Eph. 2:6, 7*). Even in our perfect, glorified bodies it will take eternity (time without end) to begin to comprehend the greatness of His grace.

Now return to Master Study Outlines for lesson number nine.

Master Outline 9

PRAYER

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER NINE

Prayer

Prayer is as old as man, as universal as religion, and as instinctive as breathing (Gen. 4:26 OT). It is practiced in some form by all men of all faiths. Prayer springs from the heart with a need—a need greater than man’s ability to encounter. Prayer is man’s acknowledgment of a being higher than himself.

Most men try to pray, yet so few know how. There are two kinds of prayers: the prayer that does not reach God and the prayer that does reach God. This is illustrated by our Lord in the parable of the Pharisee and the publican (Luke 18:9-14). Both men went to the same place, at the same time, for the same purpose—to pray.

The Pharisee prayed in his religious pride, expecting God to answer because he thought himself worthy. He informed God of his own goodness, that he was better than others. He boasted of his good works. He said, “I fast; I tithe.” This is the kind of prayer that does not reach God. It is self-righteous prayer.

Now look at the publican and his prayer. He came to God in great humility, conscious of his unworthiness, confessing himself a sinner, and begging for mercy. This is the kind of prayer that does reach God. This is righteous prayer.

It is a rare privilege to pray; because it brings you into close fellowship with God, admitting your need for Him and your utter dependence upon Him.

I. WHAT IS PRAYER?

II. WHY PRAY?

III. HOW TO PRAY

IV. WHERE TO PRAY

V. HINDRANCES TO PRAYER

VI. DOES GOD ANSWER ALL PRAYERS?

I. *Matt. 7:7-11*

Prayer is asking and receiving; it is talking with God. It is making your request known to Him in faith. The above Scripture is so simple on the surface that we are in danger of failing to recognize its immensity. Our Lord instructs the believer to ask, seek, and knock; because these three words cover the whole spectrum of prayer.

(1) Prayer is asking and receiving. When you know the will of God regarding a need, whether it be material or spiritual, you can ask and receive. This is prayer according to the revealed will of God (*1 John 5:14, 15*).

(2) Prayer is seeking and finding. When you do not know the will of God regarding a need, whether it be material or spiritual, then you are to seek His will in prayer concerning this need until you find it. This is prayer for knowledge of the unrevealed will of God in a specific need (*Col. 3:1*; also *Jer. 29:12, 13 OT*).

(3) Prayer is knocking and opening. When you know the will of God, and yet you find a closed door, you are to knock, and keep on knocking until God opens the door. This is tenacious prayer—prayer for mountain-moving faith. Knocking prayer perseveres until the impossible becomes the possible. This is miracle-working prayer (*Matt. 17:14-21*). All things are possible when you ask, seek, and knock.

Now turn to Luke 18:1, for point number II: WHY PRAY?

II. Luke 18:1

Pray:

- (1) Because Jesus said, “Men always ought to pray” (above verse 1). Prayer is imperative. You are commanded to pray (*Matt. 26:41*).
- (2) Because prayer is the only way to get things from God. “You do not have because you do not ask” (*James 4:2*).
- (3) Because there is joy in prayer (*John 16:24*).
- (4) Because prayer will save you out of all your troubles (*Ps. 34:6 OT*).
- (5) Because prayer can unlock the treasure chest of God’s wisdom (*James 1:5*).
- (6) Because prayer is a channel of power (*Jer. 33:3 OT*).
- (7) Because it is a sin not to pray (*1 Sam. 12:23 OT*).
- (8) Because sinners can be saved when they pray in faith (*Rom. 10:13, 14*).
- (9) Because Jesus, while here in the flesh, prayed often to the Father. Now if Jesus, the Son of God, needed to pray, then we should “pray without ceasing” (*1 Thess. 5:17*).

Now turn to Matt. 6:9-13, for point number III: HOW TO PRAY.

III. Matt. 6:9-13

“In this manner, therefore, pray.” Our Lord gave this as a model prayer after one of His disciples said unto Him, “Lord, teach us to pray, as John also taught his disciples” (*Luke 11:1*).

- (1) We are to pray to “Our Father in heaven” (verse 9), because He is all-wise, all-loving, and all-powerful. We are also instructed to pray in the name of Jesus (*John 14:13, 14*), depending on the mediative influence of the Holy Spirit (*Rom. 8:26, 27*).
- (2) We are to pray for His will to be done in everything.
- (3) We are to pray for the coming of the Kingdom (*Matt. 25:31-46*).
- (4) We are to pray for our daily necessities.
- (5) We are to pray for forgiveness and are to practice forgiving others.
- (6) We are to pray for the leading of the Lord and for deliverance from evil.
- (7) We are to pray in faith, for “without faith it is impossible to please Him” (*Heb. 11:5, 6*).

This model prayer is brief, to the point, and not repetitious. It is the perfect prayer.

Now turn to Acts 12:5, for point number IV: WHERE TO PRAY.

IV. Acts 12:5

There was a remarkable change in the prayer life of the disciples after the resurrection of Jesus, and it is noted again after Pentecost. Before the death of Jesus, the disciples slept while Jesus prayed in the Garden (*Matt. 26:36-46*). But after His death and resurrection:

- (1) They assembled in the upper room, waiting for the coming of the Holy Spirit; and they prayed. We should always pray when assembled with believers (*Acts 1:13, 14*).
- (2) They prayed as they went from house to house (*Acts 2:42-47*).
- (3) They prayed in the church when Peter was in prison (verses 5-19).
- (4) Paul and Silas prayed in prison (*Acts 16:25*). Here we see Christians praying in the presence of unbelievers, but not to be heard of them. Never pray to please others present; pray only to please God.
- (5) The most important place to pray is any place where you can be alone with God (*Matt. 6:6*).
- (6) We are instructed to pray in all places at all times (*1 Tim. 2:8*).

It is a great joy to be able to talk with God, any time, any place, under any condition, and to know that He will hear and answer.

Now turn to 1 Pet. 3:7, for point number V: *HINDRANCES TO PRAYER*.

V. 1 Pet. 3:7

When prayers are not answered, you should examine yourself in the light of God's Word. If you find anything not pleasing to God, confess it, believing God for forgiveness that your prayers may be answered (*1 John 1:9*).

- (1) An unharmonious relationship between husband and wife will hinder prayer (verses 1-7).
- (2) Selfishness will hinder prayer (*James 4:3*).
- (3) An unforgiving spirit will hinder prayer (*Matt. 5:22-24*). Many Christians go without answers to prayer because they have wronged others, or have been wronged and have failed to humble themselves and seek reconciliation.
- (4) Unbelief will hinder prayer (*James 1:6, 7*; also *Heb. 11:6*).
- (5) Known sin in the heart will hinder prayer (*Is. 59:1, 2 OT*; also *Ps. 66:18 OT*).

When you pray, go to God in all humility. Ask Him to reveal anything in your life that is not pleasing to Him. Then judge it; confess it, calling it by name and forsake it. Pray in all simplicity and earnestness, believing, and God will hear and answer.

Now turn to John 15:7, for point number VI: *DOES GOD ANSWER ALL PRAYERS?*

VI. *John 15:7*

The Bible is filled with answered prayers from Genesis to Revelation. You are commanded to pray, and God has promised to answer (*Jer. 33:3 OT*). In the above Scripture, there are two requirements for answers to prayer. First, you are to abide in Him; that is, to continue in Him. It means to remain in His perfect will at all cost (*Rom. 12:1, 2*). Second, His words are to abide in you; they are to become a vital part of your life. You are to be filled with and guided by His words (*Col. 3:16, 17*). Meet these two requirements, and your prayers will be answered.

(1) The answer is sometimes immediate. Peter walked on the water to go to Jesus, and as he began to sink, he prayed, “Lord, save me!” The answer was immediate (*Matt. 14:22-31*).

(2) The answer is sometimes delayed. The delay is according to His will (*Rom. 8:28*). The resurrection of Lazarus is a good example of delayed answer to prayer. Lazarus was sick. Mary and Martha sent for Jesus to come and heal him. But Jesus delayed coming until Lazarus was dead and in the tomb for four days. Then He came and raised Lazarus from the dead. The answer was delayed—but not denied (*John 11:1-44*).

(3) The answer is sometimes “no.” When God answers with a “no,” He always accompanies the answer with peace (*Phil. 4:6, 7*) and grace (*2 Cor. 12:7-10*).

(4) The answer is sometimes different from what you expect. You pray for perseverance and God sends tribulation—because “tribulation produces perseverance” (*Rom. 5:3*). God answers all your prayers—not according to your wishes, but according to His perfect will.

Now return to Master Study Outlines for lesson number ten.

Master Outline 10

FAITH

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER TEN

Faith

“The just shall live by faith.” This declaration of the Christian’s principle of life is found four times in the Bible: Hab. 2:1-5 (OT); Rom. 1:17; Gal. 3:10, 11; and Heb. 10:38. In Habakkuk we see the difference between the lives of the unjust and the just. The unjust are puffed up and live by their own self-sufficiency. But the just live by faith—their confidence is in God. To them, faith is more than a philosophy of life; it is the very principle of life (Hab. 2:4 OT). The just shall live his whole life by faith. He is saved by faith (Acts 16:31); he is kept by faith (1 Pet. 1:5); and he lives by faith (Gal. 2:20). His faith shall be tried many times and in many ways (1 Pet. 1:7), but faith will always be vindicated, because it is more than equal to any occasion. Faith knows how to wait on the Lord (Is. 40:31 OT), and it is always victorious (1 John 5:4).

Faith defies reason; it moves mountains (Matt. 17:14-21). Faith does not view facts; it never gives up (Heb. 11:32-39). Faith says, “God is working out His perfect will by His will in my life, and I can wait, endure, and suffer.” Faith does not make anything easy, but it does make all things possible.

I. WHAT IS FAITH?

II. THE IMPORTANCE OF FAITH

III. LITTLE FAITH

IV. THREE KINDS OF FAITH

V. THE HALL OF FAITH

I. *Heb. 11:1-3*

“Now faith is the substance [title deed] of things hoped for. . . .” Your faith is your title deed to eternal life. Just as a title deed is evidence of real estate, so your faith is evidence of your eternal estate in God (2 Cor. 4:18).

(1) Faith is taking God at His word and asking no questions (*Heb. 11:6*).

(2) Faith is knowing that “all things work together for good to those who love God, to those who are the called according to His purpose” (*Rom. 8:28*). Faith does not believe that all things are good, or that all things work well. It does believe that all things (good or bad) work together for good to them that love God.

(3) Faith has two sides. One side has to do with the intellect. It is an intellectual conviction that Jesus Christ is God. The other side has to do with the will. It is a volitional surrender of the will to Jesus Christ as Master. This is seen when Thomas believed and confessed, “My Lord and my God” (*John 20:28*). “My Lord”—this was volitional surrender; “my God”—this was intellectual conviction. Together you have saving faith (*John 20:31*). Saving faith is an intellectual conviction that Jesus is God, and a volitional surrender to Him as Lord (Master) of your life. By faith, the mind trusts in God; the heart responds to the love of God; the will submits to the commands of God; and the life obeys in the service of God.

(4) Faith is paradoxical. It goes beyond reason. It believes without understanding “why.” It sings in prison (*Acts 16:25*). It glories in tribulations (*Rom. 5:3*). It chooses to suffer afflictions (*Heb. 11:25*). It accepts all things as a part of God’s will (*Phil. 1:12*).

You are not born with this faith. It comes by hearing the Word of God (*Rom. 10:17*). This is why we are commanded to preach the gospel to every creature, that they may hear and believe (*Rom. 10:13, 14*).

Now turn to Eph. 6:16, for point number II: THE IMPORTANCE OF FAITH.

II. Eph. 6:16

The shield of faith is a vital part of the Christian's armor. You are to put on the "whole armor of God" (verses 10-18), because the Christian life is a warfare, a spiritual conflict. As Paul names the different parts of the Christian's armor, he comes to the shield and emphasizes its importance by saying, "Above all, taking the shield of faith . . ." (above verse 16).

For with the shield of faith, nothing can hurt you; ". . . in all these things we are more than conquerors through Him who loved us" (*Rom. 8:37*).

The importance of faith is seen in that:

- (1) You cannot be saved without faith (*John 3:36*).
- (2) You cannot live victoriously over the world without faith (*1 John 5:4*).
- (3) You cannot please God without faith (*Heb. 11:6*).
- (4) You cannot pray without faith (*James 1:6*).
- (5) You cannot have peace without faith (*Rom. 5:1*).
- (6) You cannot have joy without faith (*1 Pet. 1:8*).
- (7) You are justified by faith and not by works (*Gal. 2:16*).
- (8) You are to live by faith (*Gal. 2:20*).
- (9) You are made righteous by faith (*Rom. 10:1-4*).
- (10) Christ dwells in your heart by faith (*Eph. 3:17*).
- (11) The Holy Spirit is received by faith (*Gal. 3:14*).
- (12) "Whatever is not from faith is sin" (*Rom. 14:23*).

Faith is important because it honors God, and God always honors faith.

Now turn to Matt. 14:28-33, for point number III: LITTLE FAITH.

III. Matt. 14:28-33

At this stage in the spiritual growth of Peter, he was a man of "little faith." However, after Pentecost, he became a spiritual giant. Let us take a good look at his "little faith" and profit from it. Jesus, walking on the water in the midst of a storm, came to His distressed disciples. Peter asked to come to Jesus on the water. He must have thrilled at the thought of doing the impossible. Jesus said, "Come."

- (1) Peter did the impossible thing: He walked on the water, by faith.
- (2) Next, Peter did the conceivable thing: He saw the storm and had a second thought—he doubted. For a moment, he lost sight of Jesus. He may have turned and started back to the boat (*Luke 9:62*).
- (3) Now Peter did the natural thing: He feared destruction. Doubt always breeds fear.
- (4) Then Peter did the expected thing: He began to sink—he failed.

(5) Now Peter did the right thing: He prayed, “Lord, save me!” Immediately Jesus stretched forth His hand and caught him. Once more Peter made contact with Jesus by faith.

(6) Again Peter did the impossible thing: He walked on the water with Jesus to the boat. In this lesson, we see the success and failure of “little faith.”

Now let us recap the steps that led to failure. Peter started by faith and walked on the water. Then he saw the storm and had a second thought that led to doubt, that produced fear, that caused him to turn back, that brought about failure.

You need a faith that is bigger than the elements that would drag you down to defeat. You can have big faith by “prayer and fasting” (*Matt. 17:20, 21*) and by feeding your faith on the Word of God (*Rom. 10:17*). You can have mountain-moving faith.

Now turn to John 11:21-44, for point number IV: THREE KINDS OF FAITH.

IV. John 11:21-44

In this chapter, we see the faith of Martha in connection with the resurrection of her brother Lazarus. Now Lazarus fell ill, and Martha and her sister Mary sent for Jesus to come and heal him. Jesus delayed His coming until Lazarus was dead and in the tomb for four days. Then He came to raise him from the dead and found the limited, fundamental faith of Martha His only obstacle.

(1) Martha’s faith was limited. She said, “Lord, if You had been here, my brother would not have died” (verse 21). The death of Lazarus meant the end of Martha’s faith. She believed that Jesus had the power to raise her brother up from the sickbed, but not from the dead. Her limited faith restricted the power of Christ (*Matt. 13:58*). Limited faith is controlled by circumstances, and motivated by fear of failure.

(2) Martha’s faith was fundamental. Jesus said, “Your brother will rise again” (verse 23). These words were spoken to kindle hope and faith in Martha; but she said, “I know that he will rise again in the resurrection at the last day” (verse 24). Martha declared her fundamental faith in a great truth, but that is not enough. Jesus stated, “I am the resurrection and the life” (verse 25). Jesus was saying that He had all power over life and death. Then He asked, “Do you believe this?” (verse 26). Martha evaded the question by stating her fundamental faith in her creed (verse 27). It is not enough to believe in a creed only; faith must go beyond your creed, to the living, all-powerful Christ. Her faith limited the power of Christ (*Mark 10:27*), and “Jesus wept” (verse 35). Jesus wept when He came to raise Lazarus from the dead and found limited, fundamental faith only.

(3) At last, unlimited faith came to Martha when she consented to have the stone moved from the grave (verse 41). When Jesus first ordered the stone taken from the grave, Martha objected in unbelief (verse 39). Then Jesus, challenging her to believe, said, “Did I not say to you that if you would believe you would see the glory of God?” (verse 40). Martha believed and waited to see the glory of God, and she was not disappointed. We often hear that “seeing is believing,” but this is not so. You believe and then see. Faith comes before sight. Now Martha’s faith no longer limited the power of Christ. She consented to have the stone moved from the tomb, and Jesus “cried with a loud voice, ‘Lazarus, come forth!’” (verse 43), and Lazarus was raised up. Don’t be satisfied with limited, fundamental faith only, when you can have unlimited faith that pleases God and reveals His glory.

Now turn to Heb. 11:32-39, for point number V: THE HALL OF FAITH.

V. Heb. 11:32-39

This chapter is often called the “Hall of Faith.” You need to come here often and linger long, that your faith may become strong in the Lord; for in this Scripture we get a view of the history of Israel and the church, as it is written by faith, in the blood of the saints.

They worshiped by faith as Abel. They walked by faith as Enoch. They worked by faith as Noah. They lived by faith as Abraham. They governed by faith as Moses. They followed by faith as Israel. They fought by faith as Joshua. They conquered by faith as Gideon. They subdued kingdoms by faith as David. They closed the mouths of lions by faith as Daniel. They walked through the fire by faith as the three Hebrew children. They suffered by faith as Paul. They died by faith as Stephen, the first Christian martyr (*Acts 7:54-60*).

By faith they were patient in suffering, courageous in battle, made strong out of weakness, and were victorious in defeat. They were more than conquerors by faith. It is only by faith in the all-powerful Christ that you can be superior to circumstances, and victorious over all the evil forces that would destroy you. “Looking unto Jesus, the author and finisher of *our* faith” (above verse 2). The faith of the saints inspires us, but we look to Jesus as our example of faith.

Now return to Master Study Outlines for lesson number eleven.

Master Outline 11

THE ABUNDANT LIFE

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER ELEVEN

The Abundant Life

“... I have come that they may have life, and that they may have it more abundantly” (John 10:10). The only way into eternal life is through faith in Christ as personal Savior (John 3:15). But do not stop here; to have eternal life is great—but there is more. Christ came that you might have life more abundantly. All believers have life, but not all have abundant life. You are living beneath your privilege if you are a believer and not enjoying the abundant life.

For life to be abundant, it must have abundant resources, and the only unlimited source of life is in the person Jesus Christ the Son of God (John 14:6). To possess this fuller life, the believer must abide in Him (John 15:1-5). Dynamic, abundant living is not for just a few—it is God’s norm for all believers. It is spiritual life in depth, and without it, the Christian life becomes inane and meaningless.

If you do not have abundant life within you, you will soon yield to the carnal (fleshly) life around you (1 Cor. 3:1-4). The carnal life is circumstance-controlled; the abundant life is Holy Spirit-controlled. The carnal Christian life leads to defeat; the abundant life leads to victory in Christ. Man seems to know everything about life except how to live it abundantly. From this moment on, determine not to be satisfied with anything less than God’s best: living life abundantly.

- I. THE ABUNDANT LIFE IS A YIELDED LIFE
- II. THE ABUNDANT LIFE IS A SERVICED LIFE
- III. THE ABUNDANT LIFE IS A SEPARATED LIFE
- IV. THE ABUNDANT LIFE IS A SPIRIT-FILLED LIFE
- V. THE ABUNDANT LIFE IS A MATURE LIFE

I. *Rom. 6:10-13*

How to live the abundant life is no secret; it is revealed in our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ. “*For the death* that He died, He died to sin once for all; but *the life* that He lives, He lives to God” (above verse 10). Faith that saves identifies you with Christ in His death—this is eternal life. Faith that yields identifies you with Christ in His resurrection—this is abundant life (*Col. 3:1-4*).

- (1) It is one thing to have eternal life by faith. It is quite another thing to have abundant life by faith.
- (2) It is one thing for you to “become the righteousness of God in Him” (2 Cor. 5:21); it is another thing for you to realize His righteous life is in you (1 John 3:7).
- (3) It is one thing for you to live in Christ (2 Cor. 5:17); it is another thing for Christ to live His life through you (*Col. 1:27*).

In the above (verse 13), the believer has a choice. He may yield unto God by faith and enjoy abundant life, or he may yield to sin and endure a defeated life (*Rev. 3:1*). God would have you know the power of a yielded life; it will lift you above circumstances that circumvent abundant living. The abundant life begins when you yield to Him as Master, allowing Him to live His life through you by faith.

Now turn to Rom. 12:1, 2, for point number II: *THE ABUNDANT LIFE IS A SERVICE LIFE.*

II. Rom. 12:1, 2

To live abundantly, you must serve the Lord Jesus Christ, who Himself became our example. He served all the way to Calvary, and there He was the obedient servant, “. . . obedient to *the point of death*, even the death of the cross” (*Phil. 2:7, 8*).

In verses 1 and 2, the believer is urged to take the necessary steps for abundant living.

(1) You are to “present.” This is volitional surrender to the perfect will of God, even though you may not know God’s perfect will for your life; it is, on your part, an act of faith (*John 7:17*).

(2) You are to “present your bodies.” God must control and use the whole man. “And may your whole spirit, soul, and body be preserved blameless at the coming of our Lord Jesus Christ.” Your whole man was redeemed on the cross and sanctified (set apart for service) (*1 Thess. 5:23*).

(3) You are to “present your bodies a living sacrifice, holy, acceptable to God, *which is* your reasonable service.” This is exemplified in the life of the apostle Paul; he was a “living sacrifice.” In life, he was a “servant of Jesus Christ” (*Rom. 1:1*). In battle, he was a warrior (*Eph. 6:10-18*). In the will of God, he was a “prisoner of Jesus Christ” (*Eph. 3:1*). These words were spoken from a Roman prison; he never referred to himself as a prisoner of Rome. To the apostle, prison was a part of the perfect will of God. With this conviction, he lived abundantly (*Phil. 1:12*). In death, he was victorious (*2 Tim. 4:7, 8*).

You have been “transformed”—changed by the power of God, and no longer “conformed to this world”; but now you can be conformed to the “good and acceptable and perfect” will of God—and live abundantly!

Now turn to Rom. 1:1, for point number III: *THE ABUNDANT LIFE IS A SEPARATED LIFE.*

III. Rom. 1:1

Separation is both positive and negative. You are to be “separated to the gospel of God”—this is positive (above verse 1). You are to come out from anything that is contrary to the perfect will of God (*2 Cor. 6:17*)—this is negative.

To be separated means to be sanctified (set apart) for salvation and service.

(1) The Word of God has the power to separate the believer from sin (*John 17:17*; also *Ps. 119:11 OT*).

(2) God the Father has the power to separate the believer to the “coming of our Lord Jesus Christ” (*1 Thess. 5:23*).

(3) God the Son has the power to separate the believer to righteousness, “not having spot or wrinkle” (*Eph. 5:24-27*).

(4) God the Holy Spirit has the power to separate the believer to salvation and service (*2 Thess. 2:13*).

Without being separated, you can have relationship with God; but you cannot have fellowship with Him. You may be united to Him in Calvary, but separated from Him in sin (*Is. 59:1, 2 OT*). Without separation, you can have influence without power, movement without achievement; you may try, but not trust; serve, but not succeed; war, but not win. Without separation to God from sin, your whole Christian life will be “wood, hay, straw.” The abundant life is made possible by the death, burial, and resurrection of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ, and made a reality by being separated to Him.

Now turn to Eph. 5:18-20, for point number IV: THE ABUNDANT LIFE IS A SPIRIT-FILLED LIFE.

IV. Eph. 5:18-20

The Holy Spirit indwells every believer. You may be immature, weak, and imperfect; but, if you have been “born again” of the Spirit (*John 3:3-7*), He dwells in you (*1 Cor. 6:19*; also *Rom. 8:9*). It is one thing for you to have the Holy Spirit dwelling in you, but does the Holy Spirit have you, that He may fill you with the abundant life? The abundant life is not found in environment or circumstances, or in the things you may possess. It is found in the infilling of the Holy Spirit. “Be filled with the Spirit” (above verse 18) is a command. You may be filled many, many times (*Acts 2:4*; also *Acts 4:31*). The apostles that were filled in Acts chapter 2 were filled again in Acts chapter 4. To be filled with the Holy Spirit is to be Spirit-possessed, Spirit-empowered, Spirit-led, and Spirit-controlled (*Acts 8:26-40*).

- (1) You are filled with the Spirit that you might have joy (verses 19 and 20).
- (2) You are filled with the Spirit for service (*Acts 6:3*; also *Acts 11:22-24*).
- (3) You are filled with the Spirit for power to be a witness (*Acts 1:8*; also *Acts 2:4-7*).
- (4) You are filled with the Spirit for the hour of persecution (*Acts 7:54-60*).
- (5) You are filled with the Spirit that you may “walk in the Spirit” (*Gal. 5:16-26*).
- (6) You are filled with the Spirit that you may be led by the Spirit (*Rom. 8:14*).

How can you be filled with the Holy Spirit? First, you must desire Him to fill you. Second, you must ask Him to fill you. Third, you must believe that He does fill you (*John 4:14*; also *John 7:37, 38*).

Now turn to 2 Pet. 3:18, for point number V: THE ABUNDANT LIFE IS A MATURE LIFE.

V. 2 Pet. 3:18

“But grow in the grace and knowledge of our Lord and Savior Jesus Christ” (above verse 18). The Scriptures reveal four stages of spiritual growth in the Christian life:

- (1) The baby stage (*1 Cor. 3:1-4*). A baby thinks only of self; and, if denied the things desired, it will raise a rumpus. It seeks its own; its feelings are easily hurt and it is often jealous. A baby lives to be served—it never serves. It drinks milk, and cannot eat strong meat. It cries, but never sings. It tries to talk, but never makes sense. These infant characteristics are so prominent in the lives of many church members. They have been born into the family of God, but have failed to develop spiritually. They are spiritual babies—carnal Christians.
- (2) The little child stage (*1 John 2:12*). Some Christians grow to be little children spiritually, but stop there. Here are some of the characteristics of children: they are often untruthful, envious, and cruel. If rebuked, they become martyrs; if crossed, they are resentful and often make a scene. They are talebearers, repeating everything they hear (in adults it is called gossip). They are given to emotional outbursts, and are easily puffed up. They love praise, and will accept it from any source. They seek only the things that appeal to self. Are you a spiritual child?
- (3) The young man stage (*1 John 2:13*). Spiritual growth to that of a young man is not reached by many. He is strong and virile and is well able to overcome his enemy. He has a vision for the future and the faith and courage to tackle it. He is preparing for his productive years. You, too, can become a young man spiritually

by “[putting] away childish things” (*1 Cor. 13:11*), and grow.

(4) The father stage (*1 John 2:13*). This stage of spiritual development can be reached by all, but so few ever attain it. The spiritual father has peace with God (*Rom. 5:1*). He knows the peace of God (*Phil. 4:7*). He rejoices in his spiritual children (*1 Thess. 2:19*; also *1 Tim. 1:2*). He has learned contentment under all circumstances (*Phil. 4:11*). He knows the only source of true strength (*Phil. 4:13*). He does not brood over the past, but looks to the future (*Phil. 3:13, 14*). He knows that all things work together in his life for his eternal good (*Rom. 8:28*). He enjoys abundant life now and will enjoy it in the life to come (*Eph. 2:7*).

Now return to Master Study Outlines for lesson number twelve.

Master Outline 12

REPENTANCE

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER TWELVE

Repentance

“He who covers his sins will not prosper, But whoever confesses and forsakes them will have mercy” (Prov. 28:13 OT).

God desires truth in the inward parts (Ps. 51:6 OT) and commands all men everywhere to repent (Acts 17:30). The sinner must repent before he can become the recipient of salvation by grace through faith (Eph. 2:8, 9). Someone said, “I repented before I understood the meaning of the word, but since then as a Christian I have repented many times.”

Repentance is the gift of God (Acts 5:31; also Acts 11:18). “The goodness of God leads you to repentance” (Rom. 2:4). The goodness of God is not merited; therefore, the result of His goodness, which is repentance, is a gift. The gift of repentance is an inward change produced by the convicting power of the Holy Spirit as the Word of God is proclaimed (Acts 2:37, 38; also John 16:7, 11). The results are “repentance toward God and faith toward our Lord Jesus Christ” (Acts 20:21): faith that Christ died for our sins and that He was buried and that He rose from the dead (1 Cor. 15:1-4).

Repentance qualifies a man for salvation, but it takes faith in Christ to acquire it. True repentance is always coupled with faith. It is impossible to have saving faith and not repent. “Repentance toward God and faith toward our Lord Jesus Christ” are essential and inseparable in salvation.

Faith without repentance is the ultimate of hypocrisy, and repentance without faith in the death, burial, and resurrection of Christ is sheer folly.

I. REPENTANCE DEFINED

II. REPENTANCE PREACHED

III. REPENTANCE FROM DEAD WORKS

IV. REPENTANCE AND GOD

V. REPENTANCE, IMPOSSIBLE TO RENEW

VI. REPENTANCE, THE IMPORTANCE OF

VII. REPENTANCE, THE EVIDENCE OF

I. 2 Pet. 3:9

First, let us see that repentance is not:

(1) Sorrow, “For godly sorrow produces repentance leading to salvation” (2 Cor. 7:9, 10). Godly sorrow is a guilty feeling that leads to repentance, but it is not repentance.

(2) Penance. Penance is an act on the part of the guilty to render payment for sin. It is to make an effort in some way to atone for wrongs done against God or man. God calls all men to repentance, not to do penance.

(a) Jesus did not say, do penance and believe the gospel. He said, “Repent, and believe in the gospel” (Mark 1:15).

(b) Peter did not say, do penance and be baptized every one of you in the name of Jesus Christ. He said, “Repent, and let every one of you be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins” (*Acts 2:38*).

(c) Paul did not say, God is commanding all men everywhere to do penance. He said, “God . . . now commands all men everywhere to repent” (*Acts 17:30*). If penance is repentance, then salvation is not the gift of God, and we are not saved by grace through faith (*Eph. 2:8, 9*).

(3) Reformation. Reformation is a change brought about by the efforts of man for self-glory (*Matt. 12:43-45*). It is a turning away from known sin, or giving up a bad habit, or trying to overhaul the old nature, or turning over a new leaf, or making restitution. Judas reformed but it did not save him and neither can it save you (*Matt. 27:3-5*).

Second, let us see that repentance is:

(1) A change. The change is always evidenced in three elements.

(a) The intellectual element, a change of mind.

(b) The emotional element, a change of heart.

(c) The volitional element, a change of will.

(2) The parable of the prodigal is a perfect illustration of repentance. He had a change of mind, a change of heart, and a change of will (*Luke 15:11-32*).

(a) The intellectual element, “He came to himself.”

(b) The emotional element, “I have sinned.”

(c) The volitional element, “I will arise and go to my father.”

Repentance is a change. The prodigal had a change of mind; and his change of mind effected a change of heart; and his change of heart effected a change of will. No one is ever saved until he wills to be (*Rev. 22:17*). Repentance is a change of mind, of heart, and of will.

Now turn to Mark 1:1-4, for point number II: REPENTANCE PREACHED.

II. Mark 1:1-4

Repentance was preached in the Old Testament before the birth of Christ, and during the life and ministry of Christ. It was preached on the day of Pentecost, and in the Book of Acts after Pentecost. It is taught in the Epistles and the Book of Revelation. It is a doctrine to be preached and practiced in all dispensations.

(1) John the Baptist preached repentance.

(a) He preached the baptism of repentance (*Luke 3:3*).

(b) He preached, “Repent, for the kingdom of heaven is at hand!” (*Matt. 3:2*). He was “the voice of one crying in the wilderness: ‘Prepare the way of the **LORD**’” (*Matt. 3:3*). John’s preaching of repentance exalted Christ, denounced sin, warned of judgment; and it cost him his head (*Matt. 14:6-11*).

(2) Jesus preached repentance.

(a) He preached, “Repent, and believe in the gospel” (verses 14, 15). He went about doing mighty works and calling sinners to repent and to have faith in the good news of God.

(b) His preaching of repentance was an ultimatum, REPENT OR PERISH (*Luke 13:1-5*). Salvation by grace is for the repentant soul, and judgment without mercy for those who resist.

(3) Peter preached repentance.

(a) At Pentecost he preached, “Repent, and let every one of you be baptized in the name of Jesus Christ for the remission of sins” (*Acts 2:38*).

(b) In his second Epistle he preached that the Lord “is longsuffering toward us, not willing that any should perish but that all should come to repentance” (*2 Pet. 3:9*). Every soul that goes to hell goes against the will of God.

(4) Paul preached repentance.

(a) He preached that God “now commands all men everywhere to repent” (*Acts 17:30*). This message was given on Mars’ Hill to the intelligentsia of Athens. The results were threefold. First, some mocked; second, some procrastinated; third, some believed (*Acts 17:32-34*).

Now turn to *Heb. 6:1*, for point number III: REPENTANCE FROM DEAD WORKS.

III. *Heb. 6:1*

What does the writer of Hebrews mean by “repentance from dead works”? First, we need to see the difference between the two categories of works. They are:

(1) Good works (*Matt. 5:16*). Only saved souls can do good works and please God. Of the lost He said, “There is none who does good, No, not one” (*Ps. 14:1-3 OT*). The believer is not to hide his good works but let them be seen to the glory of the heavenly Father. Mary of Bethany anointed the head and feet of Jesus with precious ointment while He sat at the table of Simon the leper. Some of the disciples called her deed an extravagant waste. But Jesus said, “She has done a good work for Me. . . . She has done what she could” (*Mark 14:3-9*). Like Mary we are to do all we can to the glory of God, not in order to be saved but because we are saved, having no other motive. This is the way to do good works.

(2) Wicked works (*Col. 1:20, 21*). Wicked works are deeds done by the unregenerated, natural man (*1 Cor. 2:14*). He walks according to this world system. He is motivated by the “prince of the power of the air [Satan].” His talk is filled with the lust of the flesh and he lives to gratify the desires of the flesh and the natural mind. He is a child of wrath and his works are wicked because he is dead in sin (*Eph. 2:1-3*). Now for the third category. It is:

(3) Dead works (above verse 1). Dead works could be called religious works. They are done by the religious for the purpose of meriting eternal life. It is a legalistic effort to keep the moral and ceremonial laws of God for the purpose of winning God’s favor and be saved by works (*Eph. 2:8, 9*). Paul said, “Therefore by the deeds of the law no flesh will be justified in His sight” (*Rom. 3:20*).

Dead works are performed by the religious, “for they being ignorant of God’s righteousness, and seeking to establish their own righteousness, have not submitted to the righteousness of God” (*Rom. 10:1-4*).

Paul is a good illustration of repentance from dead works. He clearly stated that he had “no confidence in the flesh”; then he lists his dead works of which he had to repent (*Phil. 3:1-9*). When he compared his righteousness, which is by dead works of the law, with the righteousness of Christ, which is by faith, he counted the former lost rubbish. He knew the meaning of “repentance from dead works.”

Now turn to Heb. 7:21, for point number IV: REPENTANCE AND GOD.

IV. Heb. 7:21

“God is not a man, that He should lie, Nor a son of man, that He should repent” (*Num. 23:19 OT*). Yet the Bible tells us that He does repent (*Gen. 6:5-7 OT*). This is not a contradiction. It is paradoxical, but not contradictory.

God makes two covenants with man.

The first is unconditional. When He makes an unconditional covenant He never repents (changes His mind). He made such a covenant with Abraham (*Gen. 12:1-3 OT*). It will stand forever because “the **LORD** has sworn And will not relent” (*Ps. 110:4 OT*). He made such a covenant with Israel (*Rom. 11:25-36*).

The second is conditional. The Lord said, “My Spirit shall not strive with man forever, for he is indeed flesh; yet his days shall be one hundred and twenty years” (*Gen. 6:3 OT*). In the days of Noah, God gave the human race 120 years to repent. Only Noah and his family repented and “found grace in the eyes of the **LORD**” (*Gen. 6:8 OT*). They met God’s condition and were not judged with the rest of the human race who refused to repent. “The Lord is not slack concerning His promise, as some count slackness, but is longsuffering toward us, NOT WILLING THAT ANY SHOULD PERISH BUT THAT ALL SHOULD COME TO REPENTANCE” (2 *Pet. 3:9*). It is clear that God wills to save all lost souls. He is “not willing that any should perish.” To be saved, the lost must meet His condition, “repentance toward God and faith toward our Lord Jesus Christ” (*Acts 20:21*). Now if a man does not repent and believe in the Lord Jesus Christ, God will repent. He will change and judge that man. In love He bestows grace; but, if salvation by grace is rejected, in justice He terminates it. In this way God repents.

Now turn to Heb. 6:4-6, for point number V: REPENTANCE, IMPOSSIBLE TO RENEW.

V. Heb. 6:4-6

The key that unlocks the mystery to this difficult portion of Scripture is the word “impossible” in verse 4. The writer is saying that the person who so sins will find it impossible to repent again.

First, let us see what the writer does not mean. He does not mean a backslidden Christian. Simon Peter backslid (*Matt. 26:69-75*), repented (*John 21:3-17*), and was restored to fellowship with the Lord. King David sinned (2 *Sam. 11:1-27 OT*), repented (*Ps. 51:1-19 OT*), and was restored to fellowship with the Lord (2 *Sam. 12:13 OT*). Any backslidden Christian can repent and be restored to fellowship with God.

Second, let us see what the writer does mean. Hebrews 6:4-6 is proof that being religious is not enough to save you. They professed, but did not possess eternal life. In outward appearance they would be called Christians. But Jesus said, “Not everyone who says to Me, ‘Lord, Lord,’ shall enter the kingdom of heaven” (*Matt. 7:21-23*).

Esau so sinned against the Lord when he sold his birthright to Jacob for a bowl of pottage (*Gen. 25:27-34 OT*). Later he tried to repent, but found it impossible to do so. The Scripture says, “He found no place for repentance, though he sought it diligently with tears” (*Heb. 12:16, 17*).

At the great white throne judgment where only the wicked dead are judged (*Rev. 20:11-15*), they, too, will try to repent but will find it impossible.

Now turn to Acts 17:30, for point number VI: REPENTANCE, THE IMPORTANCE OF.

VI. Acts 17:30

Repentance is so important that God “commands all men everywhere to repent” (above verse 30).

(1) The lost are to repent. Jesus said, “I did not come to call the righteous, but sinners, to repentance” (*Matt. 9:13*). Again, He said, “Unless you repent you will all likewise perish” (*Luke 13:3-5*).

(2) Backsliders are to repent. Paul said, “Now I rejoice, not that you were made sorry, but that your sorrow led to repentance” (*2 Cor. 7:9*). There were fleshly Christians in the church at Corinth. In Paul’s first letter to them, he called upon the church to discipline the guilty. In his second letter he rejoices because the guilty repented.

(3) Local churches are to repent. In the Book of Revelation (*Rev. 2* and *Rev. 3*), our Lord sent seven letters to seven local churches. He called upon five of the seven to repent.

The church at Ephesus was to repent because she had left her first love.

The church at Pergamos was to repent because she permitted the doctrine of Balaam to be taught, she permitted the eating of things sacrificed to idols, and she allowed the commission of sexual immorality.

The church at Thyatira was to repent because she suffered Jezebel to teach and beguile God’s servants to commit sexual immorality.

The church at Sardis was to repent because she was a dying congregation.

The church at Laodicea was to repent because she thought she was rich and did not need anything. In her opinion, she had arrived. She did not know that she was neither hot nor cold, but lukewarm, and God was ready to spew her out of His mouth.

The Lord called upon these five local churches to repent or else He would remove their candlesticks and they would cease to be a light in darkness.

The lost are to repent or perish.

The backslider is to repent or be disciplined.

The local church is to repent or lose its effectiveness in a world lost in sin.

Now turn to Acts 26:19, 20, for point number VII: REPENTANCE, THE EVIDENCE OF.

VII. Acts 26:19, 20

The evidence of repentance toward God and faith toward our Lord Jesus Christ is seen in:

(1) The repentance of unbelieving Thomas (*John 20:24-29*). Thomas would not believe that Christ had been raised from the dead until he saw the risen Savior and was given the opportunity to touch His nail-pierced hands and thrust his hand into His wounded side. Thomas repented, believed, and made his great confession of faith, “My Lord and my God!”

(2) Three thousand changed their minds, hearts, and wills on the day of Pentecost and immediately gave evidence of repentance (*Acts 2:41-47*).

(3) Saul of Tarsus experienced repentance when he met Jesus on the Damascus road and gave evidence of repentance (*Acts 9:1-22*).

(4) Cornelius, his family, and his friends repented when they heard the gospel preached by Simon Peter, and evidence of repentance followed (*Acts 10:24-48*).

(5) The Philippian jailer and his house repented when witnessed to by Paul and Silas; the evidence of repentance followed (*Acts 16:26-34*).

Repentance is a change of the mind, the heart, and the will. The proof of repentance is: (1) turning from “transgressions” (*Ezek. 18:30 OT*), (2) turning to God, (3) followed by good works (verse 20).

Now turn to Master Study Outlines for lesson number thirteen.

Master Outline 13

THE NEW BIRTH

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER THIRTEEN

The New Birth

It is of the utmost importance that we have a clear understanding of what Jesus meant when, speaking with Nicodemus, He said, “You must be born again” (John 3:7). The new birth is a spiritual birth. It is as much a birth as the natural birth; it is not just a figure of speech. The first birth is of the “seed of man.” The second birth is of the “seed of God” (1 Pet. 1:23). Therefore, you cannot become a child of God by joining the church, any more than a monkey could become a man by joining the human race. He might act like a man, dress like a man, and try to live like a man—but he would still be a monkey. Now, if by some miracle, the monkey could be born again of the “seed of man,” then—and only then—could he become a man. The only way to become a child of God is to be “born again” (John 3:3), “not of corruptible seed but incorruptible, through the word of God which lives and abides forever.” This is the new birth.

The new birth is a new creation (2 Cor. 5:17).

The new birth is a spiritual resurrection (Eph. 2:1-9).

The new birth is regeneration (Titus 3:5).

The new birth is partaking of the divine nature of God (2 Pet. 1:4).

The new birth is receiving Jesus Christ as Savior and Lord, by faith (John 1:12).

The new birth is being made the “righteousness of God” (2 Cor. 5:21).

The new birth is compulsory if you are to become a child of God: “You MUST be born again” (John 3:7).

I. JESUS AND THE TWO BIRTHS

II. THE NEW BIRTH ISSUES A NEW, SINLESS NATURE

III. THE NEW BIRTH IS INCORRUPTIBLE

IV. THE NEW BIRTH—ITS MEANS

V. THE NEW BIRTH—ITS THREEFOLD PROOF

I. *John 3:1-8*

In the above Scriptures, we see Jesus and Nicodemus face to face—Jesus the Son of God, and Nicodemus the son of natural man. Nicodemus was a very religious man, but he was not a child of God. What a shock it must have been to learn that his religion was not enough! It never is. He came to Jesus, addressing Him, “Rabbi, we know that You are a teacher come from God.” Jesus knew Nicodemus, as He knows all men (verses 24, 25), and Jesus knew that he needed more than a teacher—he needed a Savior. He needed more than religion—he needed regeneration. He needed more than Law—he needed life. Jesus began by going right to the point when He said, “You must be born again.” Nicodemus asked, “How can a man be born when he is old?” Then Jesus pointed out the dissimilarity in the two births: “That which is born of the flesh is flesh [the flesh will never change], and that which is born of the Spirit is spirit [the Spirit will never change],” (verse 6).

First, let us take a brief look at the flesh birth:

(1) It produces an old, sinful nature (*Ps. 51:5 OT*).

(2) It produces a corruptible nature (*1 Pet. 1:23*).

(3) It produces an old nature under the sentence of death (*Rom. 6:23*).

(4) It produces an old nature that makes every unsaved person a child of the devil (*1 John 3:10*; also *John 8:44*).

Second, let us say a word about the new birth:

(1) It produces a sinless nature (*1 John 3:9*).

(2) It produces a nature that cannot sin (*1 John 3:9*).

(3) It produces a righteous nature (*2 Cor. 5:21*).

(4) It produces a divine nature (*2 Pet. 1:4*).

Every born again person has two natures: the old from the old birth, and the new from the new birth. By the old birth, we are children of the flesh; by the new birth, we are the children of God. This is why “you must be born again.”

Now turn to *1 John 3:9*, for point number II: *THE NEW BIRTH ISSUES A NEW, SINLESS NATURE*.

II. 1 John 3:9

This is one of the most misunderstood verses in the Bible. Do not try to understand it in the light of personal experience. Keep in mind that verse 9 is speaking of the new nature—not the old nature—because the old nature is born not of God. The old nature is born of fallen man and is depraved. The new nature is born of God and is holy.

First, let us see what this verse says about the new nature:

(1) The new nature cannot commit sin, because it is the product of the seed (sperm) of God.

(2) The new nature cannot sin, because it is the divine nature of God (*2 Pet. 1:4*); and, since God cannot sin, the new nature that issues from His holy seed cannot sin.

Second, let us see what the Bible says about the old nature:

(1) The old nature does sin any time you let it sin (*Rom. 6:12*). As a child of God, you will keep under the old nature (*1 Cor. 9:27*) by not yielding to the desire of the flesh; or the old nature will keep you under, and you will live a defeated Christian life (*Rom. 6:13*).

(2) There is nothing good in the old nature (*Rom. 7:18*). The power to live a righteous life cannot be found in the old nature; it can be found only in the new (*Gal. 2:20*).

If you have been “born again,” you have two natures—the old and the new—and you are walking according to one of the two. Examine your Christian walk in the light of God’s Word (*Rom. 8:5, 6*).

Now turn to *1 Pet. 1:23*, for point number III: *THE NEW BIRTH IS INCORRUPTIBLE*.

III. 1 Pet. 1:23

In the above verse we have two seeds, two births, and two natures.

(1) The seed of man issues a corruptible nature (*Rom. 1:23*). The seed of man became depraved in the loins of Adam when he sinned in the Garden of Eden (*Gen. 3:6-10 OT*). Corruptible man can produce only corruptible seed (*Matt. 7:18*). “All have sinned . . .” (*Rom. 3:23*); because all are born in sin (*Ps. 51:5 OT*). You are not a sinner because you sin—you sin because you are a sinner.

(2) The incorruptible seed issues an incorruptible nature (*2 Pet. 1:4*). You cannot corrupt that which is incorruptible; therefore, the incorruptible seed of God issues a new nature that cannot be corrupted at any time, or in any way. The new birth produces the life of Christ, and this life is made living in man by the indwelling Holy Spirit (*Rom. 8:8-10*).

The seed of man is corruptible; the birth of man is natural. Therefore, the nature of man is sinful.

The seed of God is incorruptible; the new birth is spiritual. Therefore, the new nature is sinless.

Now turn to *John 3:14-18*, for point number IV: THE NEW BIRTH—ITS MEANS.

IV. John 3:14-18

Moses lifted up the serpent in the wilderness (*Num. 21:5-9 OT*). He lifted up the serpent for a sinful, disobedient people. When anyone was bitten by a serpent, he had a choice: he could humble himself and by a simple act of faith look and live (*Is. 45:22 OT*); or he could refuse to look on the serpent of brass and die.

“Even so must the Son of Man be lifted up.” Just as the serpent in the wilderness was the only means for the healing of Israel, so the death of Jesus Christ is the only means for the new birth. And the only way to appropriate the regenerating power of God is by faith in the vicarious death, burial, and resurrection of Jesus Christ (*1 Cor. 15:1-4*).

The sinner must come to Christ by faith, believing:

(1) That Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures (*Is. 53:1-12 OT*; also *Zech. 13:6 OT*).

(2) And that He was buried. This is the proof of His death. He was in the tomb three days and nights.

(3) And that He rose again the third day according to the Scriptures. This is the gospel that saves—but it is powerless to save until the sinner believes it (*Rom. 1:16*).

The means of the new birth is found in that:

(1) “God so loved the world that He gave His only begotten Son”—to be the only means of the new birth (verse 16; also *Acts 4:12*).

(2) Jesus Christ gladly came into the world to become the only means of the new birth (*John 12:27*; also *John 17:1-5*).

(3) The Holy Spirit came into the world on the day of Pentecost to convince men of their need of the new birth (*John 16:7-11*). A personal faith in the death, burial, and resurrection of Jesus Christ is the only means of the new birth.

Now turn to *1 John 5:1*, for point number V: THE NEW BIRTH—ITS THREEFOLD PROOF.

V. 1 John 5:1

Every “born again” child of God has the threefold proof of the new birth—proof that he is a child of God. This threefold proof is: first, inward proof; second, outgoing proof; and third, outward proof.

(1) “Whoever believes that Jesus is the Christ is born of God” (above verse 1). My faith in Christ—that He is God—is personal evidence that I am a child of God (verses 10-13). This is inward proof of the new birth.

(2) “Everyone who loves is born of God” (1 John 4:7-11). We are to love our fellow man with the love of God. This we are not capable of doing in the flesh; we must let God love man through us (Rom. 5:5). This is outgoing proof of the new birth.

(3) “Everyone who practices righteousness is born of Him” (1 John 2:29). If you are born of God, you will make a practice of doing right at all times and at all cost (2 Cor. 5:17). This is outward proof of the new birth.

If you do not have the threefold proof of the new birth, now is the time to get on your knees and accept Jesus Christ as your personal Savior—by faith in His vicarious death, burial, and resurrection.

Now return to Master Study Outlines for lesson number fourteen.

Master Outline 14

GOD'S PLAN OF SALVATION

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER FOURTEEN

God's Plan of Salvation

There are seven facts revealed in God's plan of salvation, and as you study them, keep in mind that this is God's plan—not man's—it is God's. There is no other plan that can save your lost soul and make you a child of God (Acts 4:12).

All roads may lead to Rome, but all religions do not lead to God and salvation. There is only one way, and that is God's way; and God's way is a person, and that person is His Son the Lord Jesus Christ (John 14:6).

God's salvation is threefold: First, Christ appeared on this earth to save you from the penalty of sin, by putting away your sin by the sacrifice of Himself on the cross (Heb. 9:26). Second, He appeared in heaven, in the presence of God, after His resurrection, to save you from the power of sin (Heb. 9:24). Third, He will appear again on this earth, the second time, as "Lord of lords and King of kings" (Rev. 17:14) to save you from the very presence of sin (Heb. 9:28).

Now come to the seven facts of salvation with an open mind and a receptive heart. May God may bring salvation to your soul.

- I. IT IS A FACT THAT GOD LOVES YOU
- II. IT IS A FACT THAT YOU ARE A SINNER
- III. IT IS A FACT THAT YOU ARE NOW DEAD IN SIN
- IV. IT IS A FACT THAT CHRIST DIED FOR YOU
- V. IT IS A FACT THAT YOU CAN BE SAVED BY FAITH IN THE LORD JESUS CHRIST
- VI. IT IS A FACT THAT YOU CAN BE SAVED AND KNOW IT
- VII. IT IS A FACT THAT GOD MAKES YOU A CHILD OF GOD AS YOU OBEY HIM

I. John 3:16

It is an eternal fact that God loves you with an everlasting love that cannot be fathomed; it is so boundless that it can only be known by faith.

The little word "so" in verse 16 is most expressive. It gives you some concept of the magnitude of God's love. God so loved you, that He gave His only begotten Son, to be sin for you, that you might become the righteousness of God in Him (2 Cor. 5:21).

Jesus Christ was made that which God hates: sin—that you might become that which God loves: righteousness. Because God so loved you, you can exchange your sins for His righteousness. Could you ask for greater evidence of love? Calvary is proof that God loves, and longs to save you.

Before turning to the next fact, admit to yourself that: "God loves me."

Now turn to Rom. 3:23, for fact number II: IT IS A FACT THAT YOU ARE A SINNER.

II. Rom. 3:23

What is sin?

Sin is lawlessness (1 John 3:4). Sin is unbelief; it calls God a liar (1 John 5:10). Sin is active rebellion against God (Is. 1:2 OT). Sin is passive rebellion against God (Is. 1:2 OT). All unrighteousness is sin (1 John 5:17).

God, who cannot lie, said: “All have sinned.” “All” includes you. You have sinned against God by thought, word, and deed. You have committed sins of commission and sins of omission. In the sight of God, you are a lost sinner.

Before turning to the next fact, admit to yourself: “I am a lost sinner, because I have sinned.”

Now turn to Rom. 6:23, for fact number III: IT IS A FACT THAT YOU ARE NOW DEAD IN SIN.

III. Rom. 6:23

You have already confessed and admitted that you are a sinner. Now God would have you know that “the wages of sin is death” (above verse 23). You are dead in sin until you accept Christ as personal Savior. The apostle Paul said, “And you He made alive, who were dead in trespasses and sins” (Eph. 2:1). To be saved is to be made spiritually alive in Christ.

What is death?

(1) Death is spiritual separation. Your sins have separated you from God; you are dead in your sins.

(2) Death is physical separation. It separates the spirit and soul from the body.

(3) Death is eternal separation. If you remain lost in your sins, you will stand before God at the great white throne judgment. And there your sins will separate you from the mercy of God forever; this is Hades (Rev. 20:11-15).

You know that God loves you, and that you are a sinner—dead in sins. Before turning to the next fact, admit to yourself: “I am dead in sins.”

Now turn to Rom. 5:6-8, for fact number IV: IT IS A FACT THAT CHRIST DIED FOR YOU.

IV. Rom. 5:6-8

He died for those who are unlike God; this includes you. “While we were still sinners, Christ died for us” (above verse 8).

“For He made Him who knew no sin to be sin for us, that we might become the righteousness of God in Him” (2 Cor. 5:21).

“Knowing that you were not redeemed with corruptible things, like silver or gold, from your aimless conduct received by tradition from your fathers, but with the precious blood of Christ, as of a lamb without blemish and without spot” (1 Pet. 1:18, 19).

“For Christ also suffered once for sins, the just for the unjust, that He might bring us to God, being put to death in the flesh but made alive by the Spirit” (1 Pet. 3:18).

“Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures” (1 Cor. 15:3).

In the light of these wonderful Scriptures, will you now thank God for His great love in sending His Son to bear your sins in His own body on the cross, and admit to yourself that: “Christ died on Calvary for me”?

Now turn to Acts 16:30, 31, for fact number V: *IT IS A FACT THAT YOU CAN BE SAVED BY FAITH IN THE LORD JESUS CHRIST.*

V. Acts 16:30, 31

The Philippian jailer asked Paul and Silas: “Sirs, what must I do to be saved?” The answer was quick in response, and positive in content: “Believe on the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved, you and your household.” Paul and Silas preached the gospel to the jailer and those in his house; they believed and were saved.

What is this gospel that saves when believed? First, it is: “that Christ died for our sins.” Second: “That He was buried.” Third: “and that He rose again the third day according to the Scriptures” (1 Cor. 15:3, 4).

Jesus Christ the God-man died for you, was buried for you, and rose from the dead for you and is now at the right hand of the Father interceding for you (1 John 2:1).

“For I am not ashamed of the gospel of Christ, for it is the power of God to salvation for everyone who believes” (Rom. 1:16). The gospel is the power of God unto salvation only when you believe. Your faith in Jesus Christ releases the power of God that saves your soul.

The man born blind received physical sight by a miracle; but spiritual sight came when Jesus asked, “Do you believe in the Son of God?” He answered, “Lord, I believe!” (John 9:35-38). Salvation came to Thomas when he believed and confessed, “My Lord and my God!” (John 20:24-29).

When you confess with your mouth the Lord Jesus, and believe in your heart that God raised Him from the dead, you will be saved (Rom. 10:9, 10). Accept Him now by faith, and pray this prayer: “Lord Jesus, I know You love me, because You died on the cross bearing my sins. Thank You, Lord, for revealing to me; my lost, sinful condition. I confess that I am a sinner, dead in sin, and cannot save myself. I do now by faith, gladly accept You as my personal Savior, and thank You, Lord, for eternal salvation. Amen.”

Now turn to 1 John 5:10-13, for fact number VI: *IT IS A FACT THAT YOU CAN BE SAVED AND KNOW IT.*

VI. 1 John 5:10-13

“... That you may know that you have eternal life ...” (above verse 13). Upon the authority of God’s Word, you can be saved and know it. Your faith in God’s infallible Word is your assurance of salvation. “He who believes in the Son has [present tense] everlasting life” (John 3:36).

The Bible is a book of certainties. It strengthens convictions and establishes beliefs. God would have you know:

- (1) That you are now a child of God (1 John 3:2).
- (2) That you have been made the righteousness of God in Christ (2 Cor. 5:21; also Rom. 10:1, 4).
- (3) That you are now a new creation in Christ (2 Cor. 5:17).
- (4) That you are now a son and heir of God (Gal. 4:7). Could you have greater assurance than is found in God’s infallible Word? “Heaven and earth will pass away, but My words will by no means pass away” (Matt. 24:35).

Now turn to Acts 5:29, for fact number VII: *IT IS A FACT THAT YOU ARE NOW A CHILD OF GOD AND YOU ARE TO OBEY HIM.*

VII. Acts 5:29

“We ought to obey God rather than men” (above verse 29). You now belong to Jesus Christ. He is your Lord and Master, and “no one can serve two masters” (*Matt. 6:24*). Determine now to obey your Lord and Master, Jesus Christ, in all things:

(1) Unite with a New Testament church. “And the Lord added to the church daily those who were being saved” (*Acts 2:47*).

(2) Follow Him in the ordinance of baptism (*Acts 2:41*).

Baptism does not save; it is a witness of your faith in the death, burial, and resurrection of Christ (*Rom. 6:4*).

(3) Join a Sunday school class, and study the Word with God’s children (*2 Tim. 2:15*).

(4) Attend the worship services of your church (*Heb. 10:25*).

You need the preaching of God’s Word and Christian fellowship.

(5) Be a faithful steward (*1 Cor. 4:2*). All that you are and have belongs to God. “You are not your own. For you were bought at a price . . .” (*1 Cor. 6:19, 20*). As a faithful steward, you will pay God His tithe (*Mal. 3:10 OT*). The tithe is one-tenth of your income, and it is the Lord’s (*Lev. 27:30 OT*).

(6) Make time in your daily life to pray and read God’s Word, that you may grow in the grace and knowledge of the Lord Jesus Christ.

Now turn to Master Study Outlines for lesson number fifteen.

Master Outline 15

HOW TO WITNESS EFFECTIVELY

MASTER OUTLINE NUMBER FIFTEEN

How to Witness Effectively

One day as Jesus walked by the sea of Galilee He saw two men, Simon, called Peter, and Andrew, his brother. They were fishermen. “And He said to them, ‘Follow Me, and I will make you fishers of men’” (Matt. 4:19). Soul winners are made, not born. Therefore to be an effective witness, you must be taught, trained, and motivated by the power of the Holy Spirit.

Jesus took three years to teach and train His disciples in the art of soul winning. After His resurrection He instructed them to stay in Jerusalem and “wait for the Promise of the Father” (Acts 1:4-8). When the disciples asked Jesus if the time had come for Him to restore the kingdom of Israel, He answered, “It is not for you to know times or seasons which the Father has put in His own authority. But you shall receive power when the Holy Spirit has come upon you; and you shall be witnesses to Me in Jerusalem, and in all Judea and Samaria, and to the end of the earth.”

On the day of Pentecost, the hundred and twenty received power to witness; and any believer who will acquire the know-how can be an effective soul winner.

He can know that he and the Holy Spirit are a witnessing team. Peter said, “And we are His witnesses to these things, and so also is the Holy Spirit WHOM GOD HAS GIVEN TO THOSE WHO OBEY HIM” (Acts 5:32). Therefore, when you witness remember that “your body is the temple of the Holy Spirit who is in you” (1 Cor. 6:19, 20).

When you witness, trust the Holy Spirit to do three things:

(1) Illuminate the mind of the unbeliever.

All lost souls are in spiritual darkness (2 Cor. 4:3, 4).

(2) Stir the heart of the unbeliever.

As Peter preached Christ, the listeners were “cut to the heart” (Acts 2:37).

(3) Move the will of the unbeliever.

The prodigal returned home when he came to himself and said, “I will arise and go to my father” (Luke 15:18).

You may be up-to-date in all modern techniques of soul winning and able to quote the necessary Scriptures without a flaw; but if you do not evangelize in the power of the Holy Spirit, your soul winning efforts will be ineffective. Approach this Master Outline with an open heart and receptive mind, willing to be made fishers of men.

I. THE IMPORTANCE OF WITNESSING

II. THE QUALIFICATIONS OF A WITNESS

III. THE APPROACH

IV. THE FOLLOW-THROUGH

V. HOW TO SHARE GOD’S PLAN OF SALVATION

VI. HOW TO GIVE THE INVITATION

VII. HOW TO FOLLOW UP

I. Rom. 10:13-17

For “whoever calls upon the name of the **LORD** shall be saved” (above verse 13). Do not lift this text out of context. There are three questions in verse 14 that must be considered along with verse 13. They are:

First question, “How then shall they call on Him in whom they have not believed?” The answer is that the lost cannot call on the Lord to be saved until they believe—

- (1) “That Christ died for our sins according to the Scriptures,
- (2) And that He was buried,
- (3) And that He rose again the third day according to the Scriptures” (1 Cor. 15:1-4).

Second question, “How shall they believe in Him of whom they have not heard?” The answer is that the lost cannot believe in Him until they hear the good news of salvation.

- (1) The eunuch had to hear to believe (Acts 8:26-39).
- (2) Paul had to hear to believe (Acts 9:1-18).
- (3) Cornelius had to hear to believe (Acts 10:1-48).
- (4) The Philippian jailer had to hear to believe (Acts 16:25-40).

Third question, “How shall they hear without a preacher [witness]?” The answer is that they cannot hear the good news of salvation without a witness.

- (1) Three thousand were saved at Pentecost because the 120 witnessed.
- (2) The eunuch was saved because Philip witnessed.
- (3) Paul was saved because Stephen witnessed (Acts 7:54-60), and Jesus the God-man witnessed, and Ananias witnessed (Acts 9:1-18).
- (4) Cornelius and his household were saved because Peter witnessed.
- (5) The Philippian jailer and his household were saved because Paul and Silas witnessed.
- (6) You were saved because someone witnessed to you.

According to the Word of God the lost cannot be saved without a witness. They must have a witness to hear; they must hear to believe; they must believe to call; and they must call to be saved. But they cannot call until they believe and they cannot believe until they hear and they cannot hear without a witness. “So then faith [saving faith] *comes* by hearing” (verse 17). We are not born with saving faith; it comes only when we hear the gospel. Therefore, it is of utmost importance that every born again child of God obey the Great Commission to evangelize, to GO WITH THE GOSPEL.

Now turn to Col. 2:6, 7, for point number II: THE QUALIFICATIONS OF A WITNESS.

II. Col. 2:6, 7

A qualified witness is one who is:

- (1) Established in the faith. To be established in the faith is to be rooted and grounded in God’s Word. Peter said, “Always *be* ready to *give* a defense to everyone who asks you a reason for the hope that is in you, with meekness and fear” (1 Pet. 3:15).

The fifteen Master Outline studies in the Christian Life New Testament were prepared to help establish you in the faith. Study them, carry this Christian Life New Testament with you, and take advantage of every opportunity to ponder a portion of one of the great doctrines. They will give you a foundation on which to build a strong faith (2 *Tim.* 3:16, 17).

(2) Saved and knows it. I know that I am saved because God tells me so in His word and God cannot lie. We have:

(a) The witness of the Spirit (*Rom.* 8:16).

(b) The witness of the Word (1 *John* 5:13).

(c) The witness of saving faith, “He who believes in the Son of God has the witness in himself” (1 *John* 5:9, 10).

(3) Separated. Paul said that he was “separated to the gospel of God” (*Rom.* 1:1-16). This is positive separation and Paul analyzed it as:

(a) A holy desire to share spiritual gifts (verse 11).

(b) A holy purpose to bear fruit (verse 13).

(c) A holy obligation to pay a spiritual debt (verse 14).

(d) A holy eagerness to share the gospel (verse 15).

(e) A holy boldness to exalt the cross (verse 16).

To be separated unto the gospel is to share the Good News with the lost.

(4) Filled with the Holy Spirit. “Be filled with the Spirit” (*Eph.* 5:18). We are commanded to be filled with the Holy Spirit.

Evidence of the Spirit-filled life as seen in the early Christians:

(a) They spoke the word of God with boldness (*Acts* 4:31).

(b) They witnessed with great power (*Acts* 4:33).

(c) They witnessed with great grace (*Acts* 4:33).

(d) They shared their wealth (*Acts* 4:34-37).

(e) They worshiped in unity (*Acts* 2:42-47).

(f) They suffered persecution (*Acts* 8:1-4).

(g) They gloried in tribulations (*Rom.* 5:3).

(h) They sang in prison (*Acts* 16:25).

(i) They loved and prayed for their executioners (*Acts* 7:54-60).

(j) They rejoiced to suffer shame for His name (*Acts* 5:41).

They were accused of:

(1) Filling Jerusalem with the gospel (*Acts* 5:28).

(2) Turning the world upside down (*Acts* 17:6).

The 120 Spirit-filled Christians witnessed on the day of Pentecost and the people were:

(1) Astonished, that is, they were mentally arrested (*Acts* 2:6).

(2) Amazed, that is, they were mentally frustrated (*Acts 2:7*).

(3) Marveling, that is, they stood in mental awe (*Acts 2:7*).

(4) Mocking, that is, some mentally reacted (*Acts 2:13*).

(5) Inquiring, that is, some mentally acted (*Acts 2:37*).

The gospel proclaimed in the power of the Holy Spirit will motivate the hearer to act or react.

On the day of Pentecost three thousand acted as evidenced by repentance and baptism, while others reacted mocking. No one, but no one, ignored the witness of those Spirit-filled believers.

Now turn to *John 1:40-42*, for point number III: *THE APPROACH*.

III. *John 1:40-42*

There are two ways to approach the person to whom you are witnessing. The first is:

(1) The direct approach. This approach can be used when witnessing to:

(a) *A relative*. Andrew used the direct approach to bring his brother Simon Peter to Christ (verses 40-42).

(b) *A friend*. Philip the apostle used the direct approach to bring Nathanael to Jesus (verses 45, 46).

(c) *The concerned*. Jesus used the direct approach to win Nicodemus (*John 3:1-21*).

(d) *The seeker*. Paul and Silas used the direct approach to lead the Philippian jailer to Jesus (*Acts 16:19-34*).

The second is:

(2) The indirect approach. This approach can be used when witnessing to:

(a) *A stranger*. Jesus used the indirect approach to witness to the Samaritan woman (*John 4:7-26*).

(b) *The religious*. Philip the evangelist used the indirect approach to lead the Ethiopian eunuch to Christ (*Acts 8:26-39*).

The method in either case will vary according to the leading of the Holy Spirit. Whether you use the direct or the indirect approach, be sure to follow through until you have presented God's plan of salvation and invited them to accept Christ as their personal Savior.

Now turn to *Matt. 13:3-8, 18-23*, for point number IV: *THE FOLLOW-THROUGH*.

IV. *Matt. 13:3-8, 18-23*

The parable of the sower illustrates the importance of the follow-through. Only one-fourth of the soil was ready for the seed, so only one-fourth of the seed brought forth fruit. Jesus explains the parable in verses 18-23, and we learn that:

(1) The sower is the witness.

(2) The seed is the Word of God.

(3) The soil is the heart.

We also learn that there are four types of hearts. They are:

(1) The hard heart; this is the wayside soil, fertile but hard.

(2) The shallow heart; this is the stony soil, fertile but depthless.

(3) The worldly heart; this is the thorny soil, fertile but possessed.

(4) The understanding heart; this is the good soil, fertile and prepared.

The lesson here is a simple one: if we expect the seed, the Word of God, to bear fruit, the heart must be made ready. The hard heart must be broken; the shallow heart must be given depth; and the worldly heart must be taught that the things of this world are temporal (*Mark 8:36, 37*). This requires time, work, and patience.

Now turn to Acts 4:12, for point number V: HOW TO SHARE GOD'S PLAN OF SALVATION.

V. Acts 4:12

There are seven simple steps to take in sharing God's plan of salvation:

(1) Share your personal experience of salvation. Don't give your life story. It should not take more than a few minutes to tell how the Lord saved you. As you come to the close of your testimony, bring out your Christian Life New Testament and say, "May I share with you God's plan of salvation that changed my life?"

(2) Now share fact number I on *John 3:16*, IT IS A FACT THAT GOD LOVES YOU. Read *John 3:16* and the note at the bottom of the page on the love of God. When you come to the close of the note, say something like this: "Tom, will you now admit that God loves you?" Lead him to admit it if you can. This will get him involved in the plan of salvation.

(3) Now share fact number II on *Rom. 3:23*, IT IS A FACT THAT YOU ARE A SINNER. Read the Scripture and the note; and, as you come to the close of the note, ask him to admit that he is a lost sinner. When he admits that he is a lost sinner, you say something like this: "Tom, isn't it wonderful? God loves you even though you are a lost sinner."

(4) Now share fact number III on *Rom. 6:23*, IT IS A FACT THAT YOU ARE NOW DEAD IN SIN. Read the Scripture and the note; and, as you come to the close of the note, ask him to admit that he is dead in sin. When he admits that he is dead in sin, say something like this: "Tom, isn't it great? Even though you are a lost sinner dead in sin, God loves you."

(5) Now share fact number IV on *Rom. 5:6-8*, IT IS A FACT THAT CHRIST DIED FOR YOU. Read the Scripture and the note; and, as you come to the close of the note, ask him to admit that Christ died on Calvary for him. Say something like this: "Tom, isn't it wonderful? Isn't it great that God loves you so much that He died on Calvary bearing your sins?"

(6) Now share with him fact number V on *Acts 16:30, 31*, IT IS A FACT THAT YOU CAN BE SAVED BY FAITH IN THE LORD JESUS CHRIST. Read the Scripture and the note; and, as you come to the close of the note, be ready to ask him to accept Christ as his personal Savior.

(7) Now lead him to call upon the name of the Lord in prayer: For "whoever calls on the name of the LORD shall be saved" (*Rom. 10:13*).

Now turn to Rev. 22:17, for point number VI: HOW TO GIVE THE INVITATION.

VI. Rev. 22:17

To give the invitation is to invite the person witnessed to, to accept the Lord Jesus Christ as his personal Savior by faith. As you finish reading the note on *Acts 16:30, 31*, say something like this:

“Tom, will you kneel with me in prayer as I ask the Lord to save you, right here and now?” (Don’t wait for him to get on his knees; you lead the way. If he will not kneel with you, don’t force it; pray a short prayer that the Lord will convict him of sin and bring him to repentance. Get up and make an appointment to return for another witness session. If he does kneel with you, pray a brief prayer and ask the Lord to save him now.)

Now ask him to pray after you the prayer of acceptance on *Acts 16:30, 31*. You pray, “Lord Jesus, I know you love me.” Now he prays, “Lord Jesus, I know you love me.” Continue in this manner until you have led him through the prayer.

Now when you have finished leading him through the prayer stand up and say, “Tom, did you by faith accept the Lord Jesus Christ as your personal Savior as you prayed, ‘I DO NOW BY FAITH, GLADLY ACCEPT YOU AS MY PERSONAL SAVIOR, AND THANK YOU, LORD, FOR ETERNAL SALVATION’?” When he answers yes, take him by the hand and say, “UPON THE AUTHORITY OF GOD’S WORD YOU ARE NOW A CHILD OF GOD.” Then read *Rom. 10:13*, for “WHOEVER CALLS UPON THE NAME OF THE LORD SHALL BE SAVED.”

Now turn to Acts 2:41-47, for point number VII: HOW TO FOLLOW UP.

VII. Acts 2:41-47

When you have led a soul to Christ your responsibility does not end. You have a spiritual baby, and that baby needs help if it is to grow in the grace and knowledge of the Lord Jesus Christ. There are seven things that you can do that will help the new Christian to grow spiritually.

(1) Give him the Christian Life New Testament if he does not already have one. Now ask him to turn to Page 463 and sign his name and the date of his new birth. There is also a line for the soul winner’s name.

(2) Explain the Master Outline system of study. Show him all Fifteen Master Outlines in the front of the New Testament and how they work. Now lead him to sign on the last line on Page 463 promising to study all Fifteen Master Outline lessons.

(3) Now show him how he can know that he is saved. Turn to *1 John 5:10-13* for fact number VI. As you take him through the note, be sure to look up each Scripture reference and point out that we have a “now salvation.”

(4) Now turn to *Acts 5:29* for fact number VII. Start him out right; stress the fact that we are to obey the Lord in all things.

(5) Lead him into a New Testament church. Say something like this: “Tom, I am a member of a New Testament church, and I want you to be my guest at the next service.” Take him to church and sit with him; and, when the invitation is given, ask him to go forward with you to make his public profession of faith in Christ (*Matt. 10:32*).

(6) Encourage him to witness. “Let the redeemed of the **LORD** say so” (*Ps. 107:2 OT*).

(7) Now help him through the Fifteen Master Outlines in the Christian Life New Testament. When you have reached Master Outline Number Fifteen, he should be in the church, with a doctrinal foundation on which to

continue to grow spiritually. And by now he should be involved in evangelism. He is ready to GO WITH THE GOSPEL.
